

OUT

PLAY



DOMINATE 1V1'S DOMINATE POSSESSION

DAN WRIGHT

Thanks for downloading!



ANY QUESTIONS?

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Using the plans

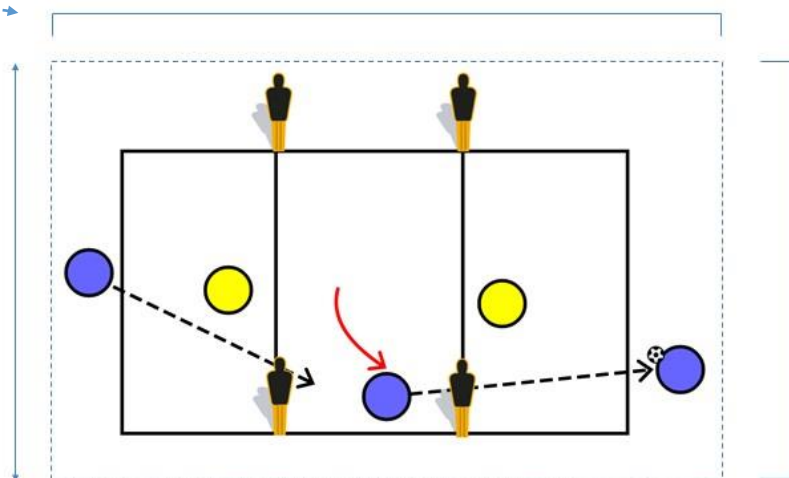
TITLE: Here you will find the name of the practice

NUMBER:
This is the practice number

Receiving between the lines

24

DIAGRAM:
A visual of what the practice might look like.



- # of players** This practice works best with 5 players. It can be adapted so more players play in the central area, or multiple groups of 3 play in the same space.
- organisation** A twist on a traditional passing and receiving drill. The central midfielder works in a central strip looking to receive the ball from the server and pass to the all to the opposite end.
- objective** The defenders (Yellow) look to screen and intercept passes into the central midfielder. The midfielder is getting repetition of receiving to play forwards.
- observe** Does the midfielder take up and adjust his position to receive the ball on the half turn, to play forwards quickly?
- progressions** Allow the Yellow to press from behind once the ball enters the central zone.
- Remove all zones and play 1v2 in the central area...this will be tough!

SESSION DETAILS: In this section you will find details around how the practice is organised, what the objectives are, what you should look out for and some progressions to advance the practice.

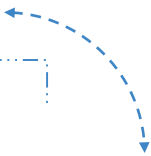
“

There is only one
ball, so you need
to have it.

Johan Cruyff

”

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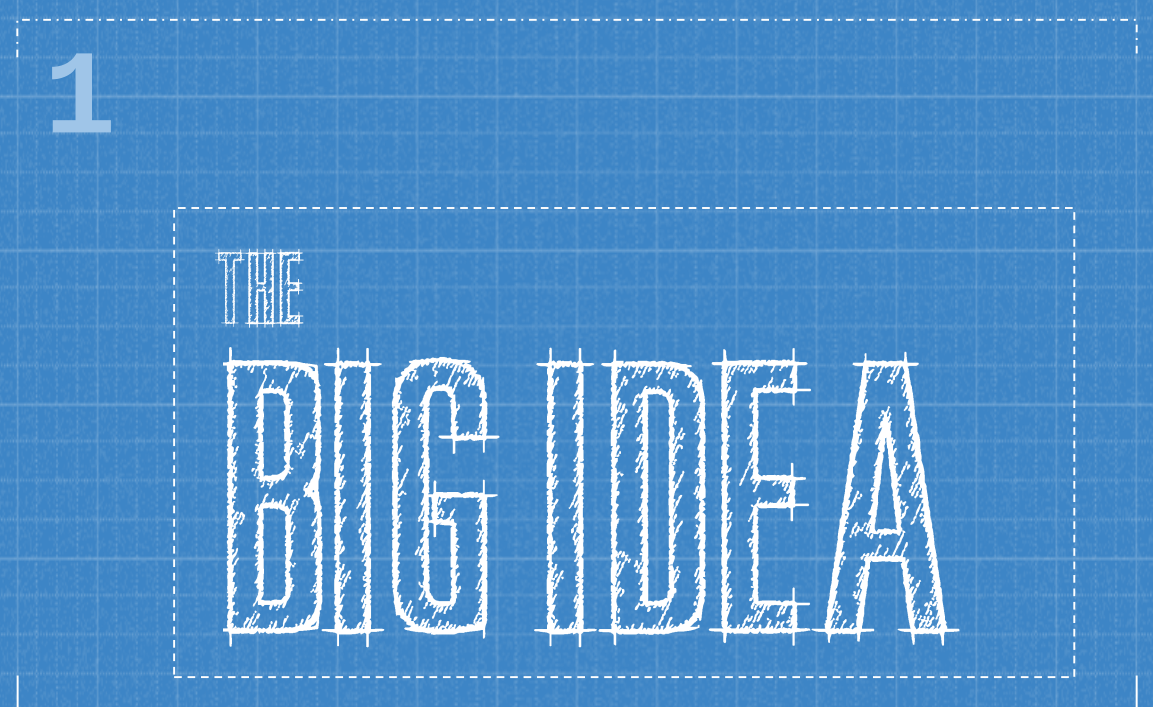


SESSION	TITLE
01	Pressure from behind
02	Receiving to turn
03	1-2 Or Dribble?
04	1v1 Hide the ball
05	1v2 Hide the ball
06	1v1 Directional
07	Beat the block
08	Breakout
09	4 gate 1v1
10	Gauntlet
11	Movement to receive
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13	Face-to-face: Positive touch
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17	Pressure from behind 2 goals
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20	Outplaying as #9 and #10

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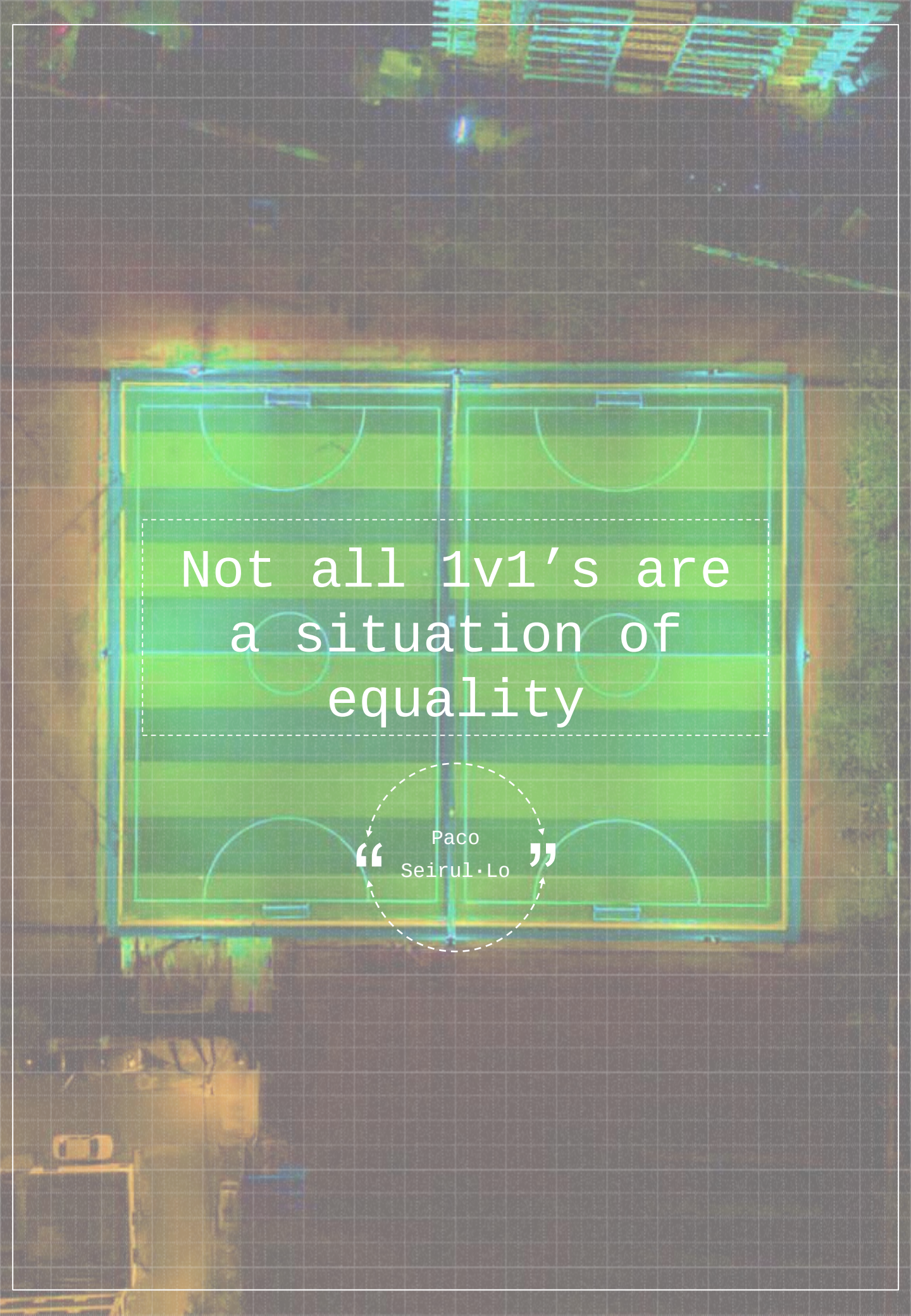
SESSION	TITLE
21	Turn and shoot
22	2 ball fake and finish
23	Finish under pressure
24	Receiving between the lines
25	Playing through 360°
26	Beat the man out wide
27	Winger inside
28	Overload in the final third
29	3v1 breakout
30	4 goal game 1v1
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32	2v2 'locked in'
33	Central midfielder relationships
34	Magic man!
35	2v2 finishing
36	Hook the #9
37	Playing out
38	Midfield rotation
39	2v2 connection
40	#10 receiving in the pocket



1

THE BIG IDEA

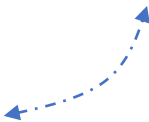
Developing the individual in the team



Not all 1v1's are
a situation of
equality

“ Paco
Seirul·Lo ”

Outplay!



MOST COACHES PRACTICE 1V1'S BUT ARE WE DOING IT RIGHT AND MORE IMPORTANTLY ARE WE MEETING THE DEMANDS OF THE GAME?

Since February 2017, this is a question I have been asking myself. In the blog "individual possession", I tried to further understand;

What do 1v1's really look like?
How do they differ from player to player?
What skills do players need to play in the future game?
How do we design practices to encourage these behaviours?

Many coaches refer to this as "Outplaying", in its simplest form this means to win your 1v1 and therefore "Outplay" your opponent. It is widely accepted that there are 6 different types of 1v1's;

- With the defender in front or 'face to face'
- With the defender adding pressure from behind*
- With the defender adding pressure from the side
- The defender recovering from an angle
- Aerial duels including versions of the above

The key points in these practices are;

Hide the ball from your opponent, don't show it too easily so they can toe it away!

Don't fear the pressure, too many players want to dump the ball off under pressure when in reality the game changers enjoy these moments.

Players must **scan** and be aware of the angle, approach and speed of the defender. This will allow them to make the best choice, to turn or hold the ball.

In some instances, the weight of pass and speed of defender might allow the attacker to *"beat the defender without actually beating him"*.

Use what you have. If you are strong, use your strength. If you have good control, turn sharply. If you are quick, explode with pace. You get the picture.

Use your body...Hands, Hips (and Bum) to feel the pressure and roll out

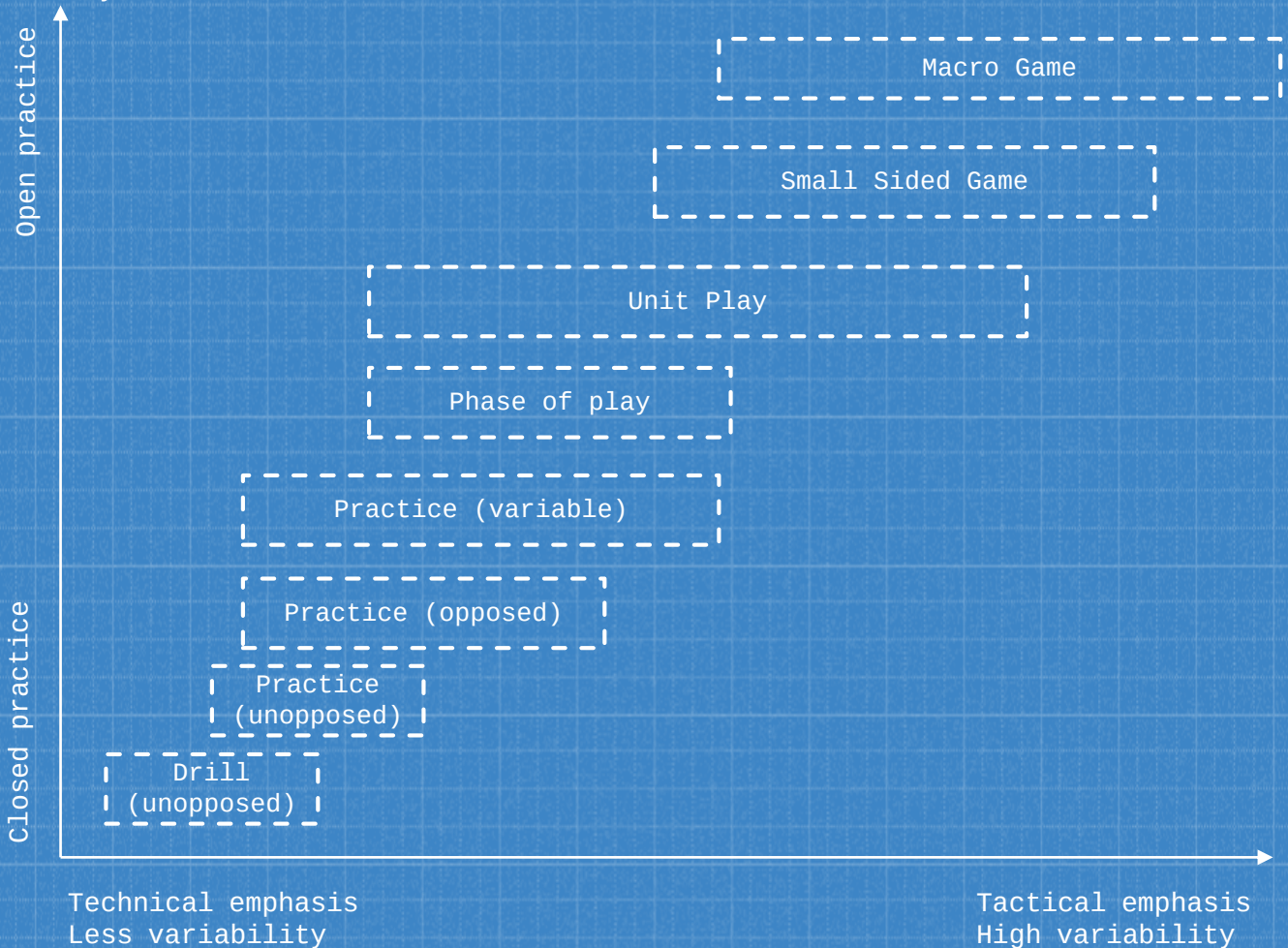
When you're free...eyes up to make the next decision. Once you've eliminated the defender, **make it count**.

We are trying to develop and encourage qualitative superiority, this means one player is better than another player in the specific scenario in terms of their playing identity. When coaching younger players do they know what they are good at? Or as some coaches call it their "Super strength".

*In the elite game approximately 75% of all receiving situations occur with pressure coming from behind.

The Environmental Design Continuum

Danny Newcombe



Understanding where the practice sits..

When planning a session or collection of practices, it is important to consider where the practice sits on the continuum. This model shows how practices can move from constant to variable to random. These practices will have different returns. The intention of the practice must always be clear in the coach's mind, then they must design the landscape for the performer to learn. It is not as simple as drills are bad and games are good, it is important to understand the returns of each practice.

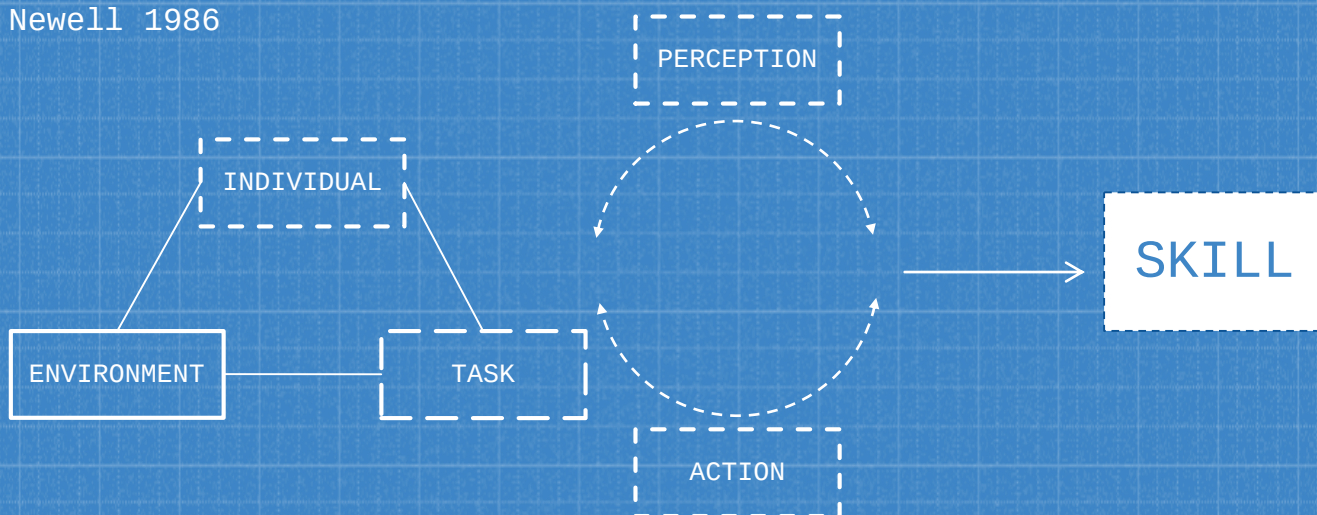
"I never teach my pupils. I only attempt to provide the conditions in which they learn" (Albert Einstein).

Creating uncertainty

When creating a positive learning environment for the players, the coach might want to consider the level of certainty they are creating. At the lower end of the spectrum there are generally less decisions and therefore lots of certainty. As you move towards the opposite end, the players are placed in more variable and dynamic situations, which will create uncertainty for the performer. The craft of the coach is creating *"Safe uncertainty"* as *"genuine learning is often characterised by significant changes to ways of doing things, not just on-going refinement/optimisation"* (Mark Upton).

CONSTRAINING TO AFFORD...

Newell 1986



"You've got to have a philosophy on skill." Ric Shuttleworth

If we believe that every learner is different, then surely we cannot impose the same process of learning on all individuals and to program everyone the same way. The Constraint Led Approach (CLA) has become increasingly popular amongst coaches, some of the principles that underpin this ecological approach are;

- The mutuality of the performer and the environment
- Perception and action are coupled
- Performance emerges as a consequence of the interaction of the constraints; Self organisation under the constraints
- The individual is the focus
- Promotes natural (implicit) learning

"Constraints are defined as providing the boundaries within which learners can explore and search for movement solutions afforded to each individual within a perceptual motor workspace." (Davids et al 2008).

Repetition without repetition

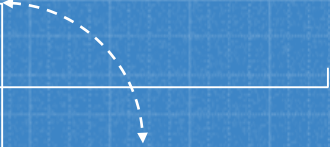
The behaviour emerges via a process of self organisation as a result of the key constraints that are interacting. *"Coaches need to identify the key constraints that impinge of the system"* (Newell, 1986).

For learning to transfer from training to games, practice needs to be representative of the game. *"Representative tasks ensure that the processes of cognition, perception and action are functionally intertwined and integrated during each athlete's performance"* (Pinder et al 2011). This means the learner needs to develop the capacity to search for and discover functional movement solutions, not just repeat actions for the sake of it or to a pre-planned routine set by a coach. With this in mind...

- All practices should be transferable to the real game
- Practice should take place in perceptually realistic environments
- Design practice environments that allow decision-making to emerge naturally

Does your environment; offer, invite, encourage your learners to explore the opportunities for action related to your development focus?

Manipulating the constraints



Individual Constraints

These are constraints that are specific to the individual performer, for example;

- Structural or physical aspects of the learner including size, shape, flexibility, fitness etc.
- Functional or behavioural aspects such as training age, motivation, anxiety, confidence...etc.

Environmental Constraints

These are the constraints that the performer operates in;

- Physical - pitch, weather, wind, altitude...etc.
- Sociocultural constraints - national/sporting culture, group, background, peers...etc.

Task Constraints

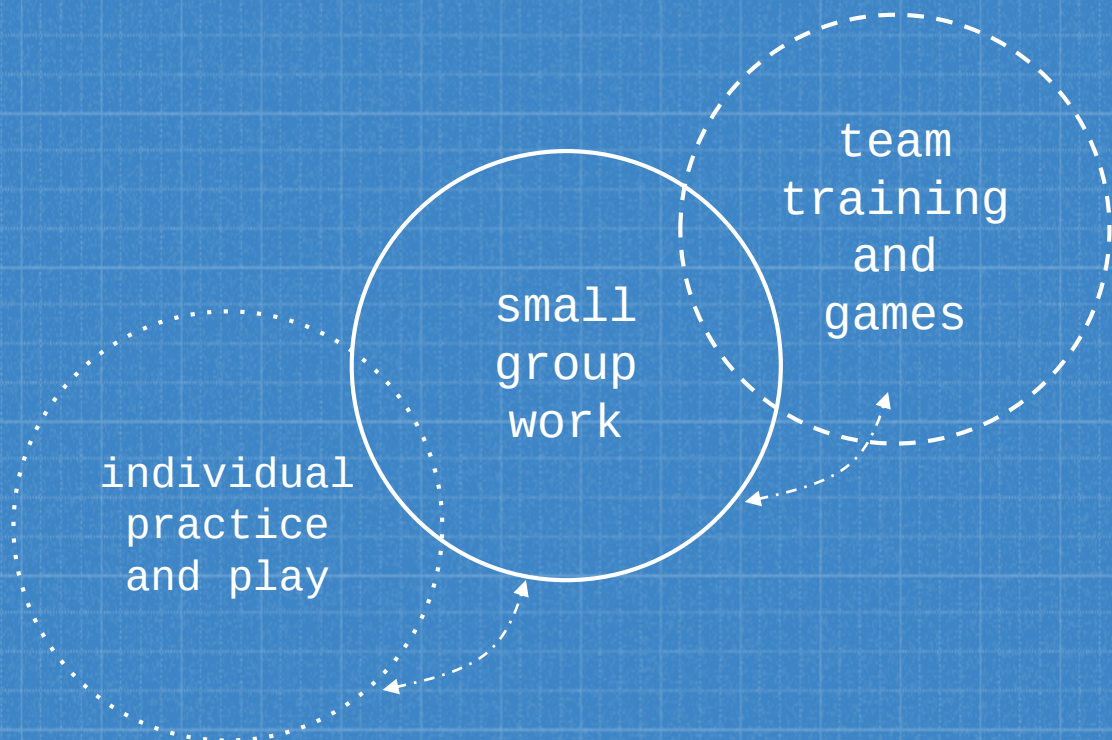
These are the constraints that coaches are most familiar with and can include;

- Scoring Mechanisms
- Numbers
- Game Rules
- Equipment
- Time

The importance of individual practice

Whilst acknowledging that skill is an emergent feature and occurs in the context, it would be naïve to think that individual practice isn't important. The hours spent mastering the ball are vital, in my experience the best players spend time on their own with the ball. If you listen to any players' journey they will talk about the time spent practicing, often in an informal setting away from the team.

There are many excellent coaches, programmes and resources that detail moves, skills and ball mastery, which are especially beneficial in the foundation age groups (7-12). These practices look at the next stage of development, performing in the context of the game.



The Principles of play

The FA / The England DNA



IN POSSESSION

PENETRATION

CREATE SPACE

MOVEMENT

SUPPORT

CREATIVITY

OUT OF POSSESSION

PRESS

DELAY

COVER & BALANCE

COMPACTNESS

CONTROL &
RESTRAINT

Developing individuals in the team...

These principles provide a framework and priority order for what our teams do in and out of possession. When focusing on individuals or designing a session to develop individuals it is important that the practice adheres to and promotes the 'principles of play'. This will enable the individual to fit into the framework of a team and ultimately get success.

The risk of coaching without using these principles is it could lead to attuning the player to artificial information, which might not exist in the game. This means that they are practicing or learning skills that will not transfer to the game and ultimately will fail when it matters.

Note: These are the FA's Principles of play, your interpretation or principles might be different.

Speaking the same language

BREAKING DOWN SOME OF THE LANGUAGE IN THESE PRACTICES

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
back foot	Receiving the ball with the foot furthest away from the passer. Some people also use the "top foot" or "front foot", it all means the same thing.
escape	This is the language I use when leaving the 1v1. Escape might occur after a good turn, trick, use of pace or a change of direction.
hide	The attacker moving the ball so the opponent can not see it. Using his body to conceal the ball, often from foot to foot and placing his body between ball and defender.
playing in the future	This refers to playing with the next move in mind before the ball arrives.
positive touch	This means receiving the ball thinking about the next action. So it could mean a touch into space, a touch towards the next pass or a touch to eliminate an opponent.
roll	When the attacker uses his body to feel the defender before turning (rolling) into space to evade him.
safe side	Receiving the ball or passing the ball to the "safe side" away from the defender.
scan	Looking and being aware of our surroundings, checking through 360 degrees before receiving the ball, in order to see teammates, defenders...etc.
shield	Very similar to "hide", using the body to protect the ball. Shield might mean the opponent can see the ball, but strength or positioning of the attacker means he can't get it.
twist & turn	The ability to change direction quickly with a low centre of gravity to wriggle away from pressure.
wriggle	This is a term I like to use for young players, which is similar to "gaining half a yard". In my mind it encourages the player to stay on the ball and wriggle out of pressure...to shoot, to dribble and to outplay!

different types of 1v1



Defender in front or "face to face"

Defender adding pressure from behind

Defender adding pressure from the side

Defender recovering from different angles

No defender due to movement to avoid pressure

Aerial duels

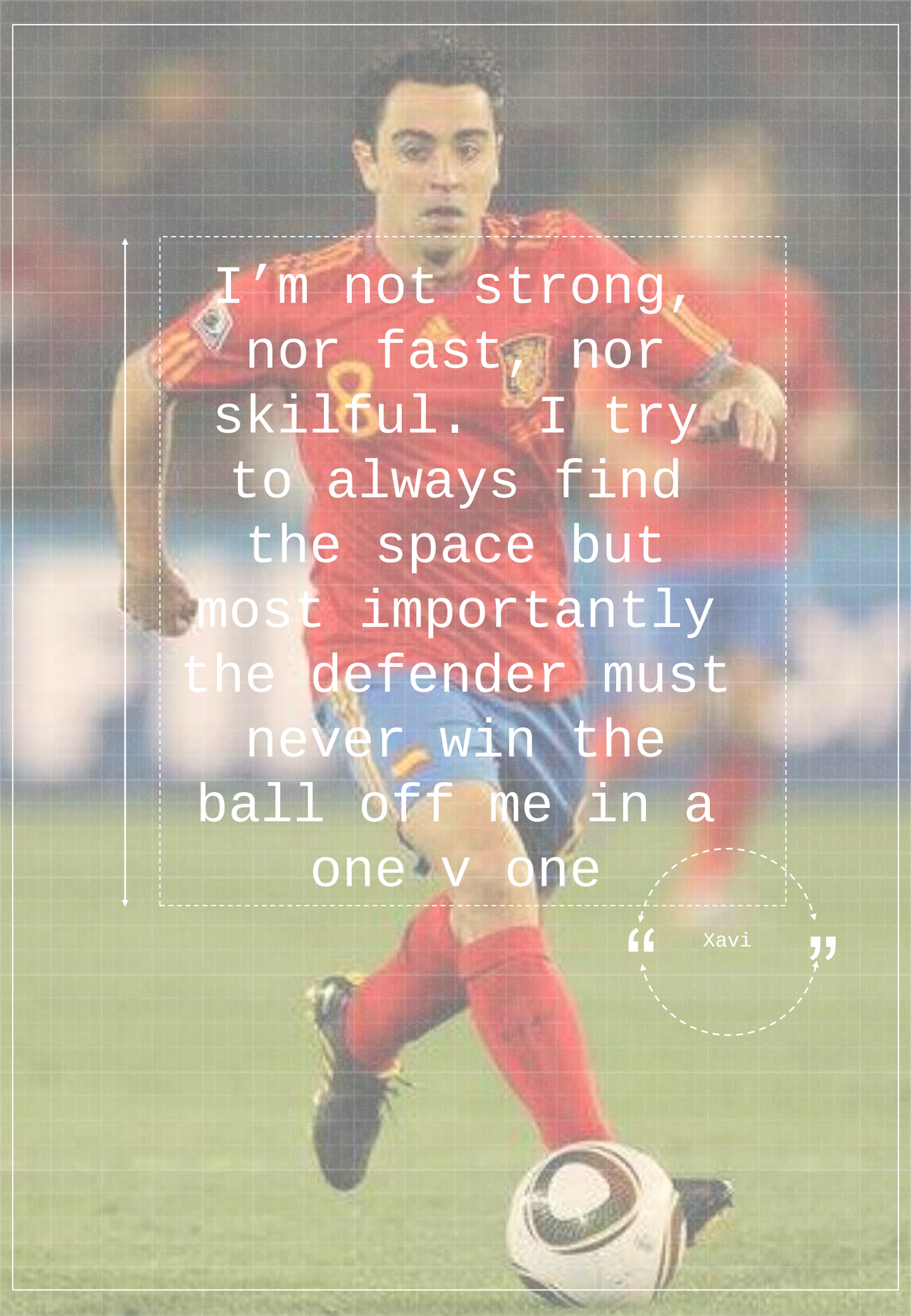
When designing practices it is important that we understand and explain to the players that there are different types of 1v1. In the book '*Developing an Elite Coaching philosophy*' by Tim Lees, these are broken down into 6 different types of 1v1's.

It might be useful to consider;

- When will these moments occur in the game?
- Different players will beat the opponent in different ways.
- Will players need different skill sets when playing in different positions?



2 THE PRACTICES

A full-page background image of Xavi Hernandez in a red Spain national team jersey, number 8, running with a soccer ball on a green field. The image is overlaid with a white grid pattern. A dashed white box encloses the text, and a vertical double-headed arrow is to its left. A circular dashed line with arrows at the bottom right encloses the name 'Xavi'.

I'm not strong,
nor fast, nor
skilful. I try
to always find
the space but
most importantly
the defender must
never win the
ball off me in a
one v one

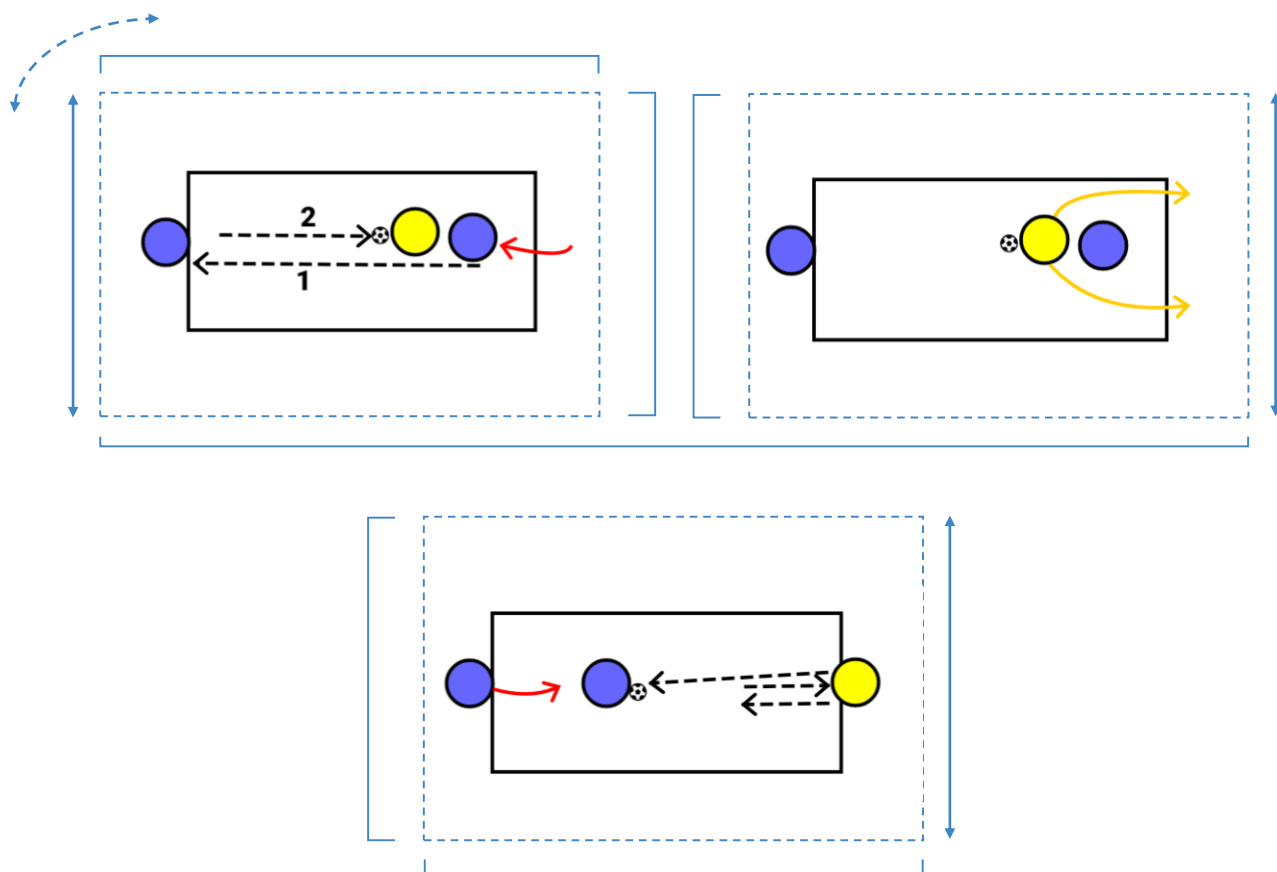
“

Xavi

”

Pressure from behind

01



of players The minimum group size for this practice is 3.

organisation Players working in 3's, unopposed but with pressure.

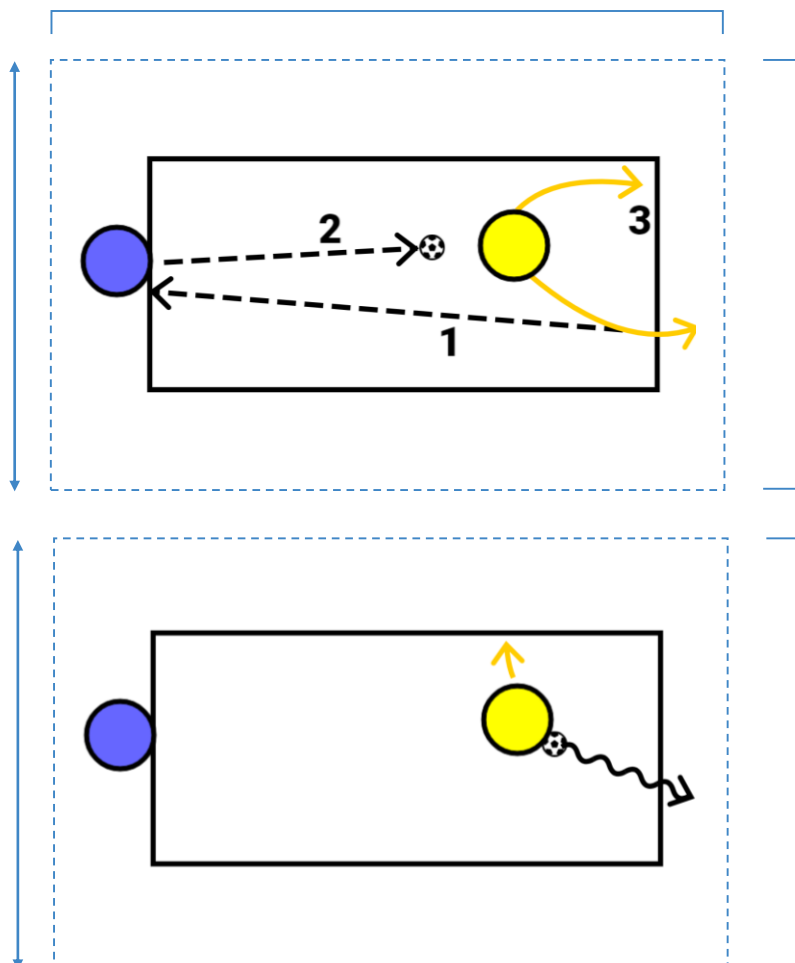
objective The first player (Yellow) passes into the end player and moves into the centre (Top Left). The second player sets the ball back whilst the third player presses from behind. The Yellow player now must twist and turn to roll and escape either side. Practice then repeats itself so all players perform all roles.

observe Does the attacker hide the ball from the opponent using his hands, hips and bum?

How does the attack escape the pressure, does he demonstrate variety?

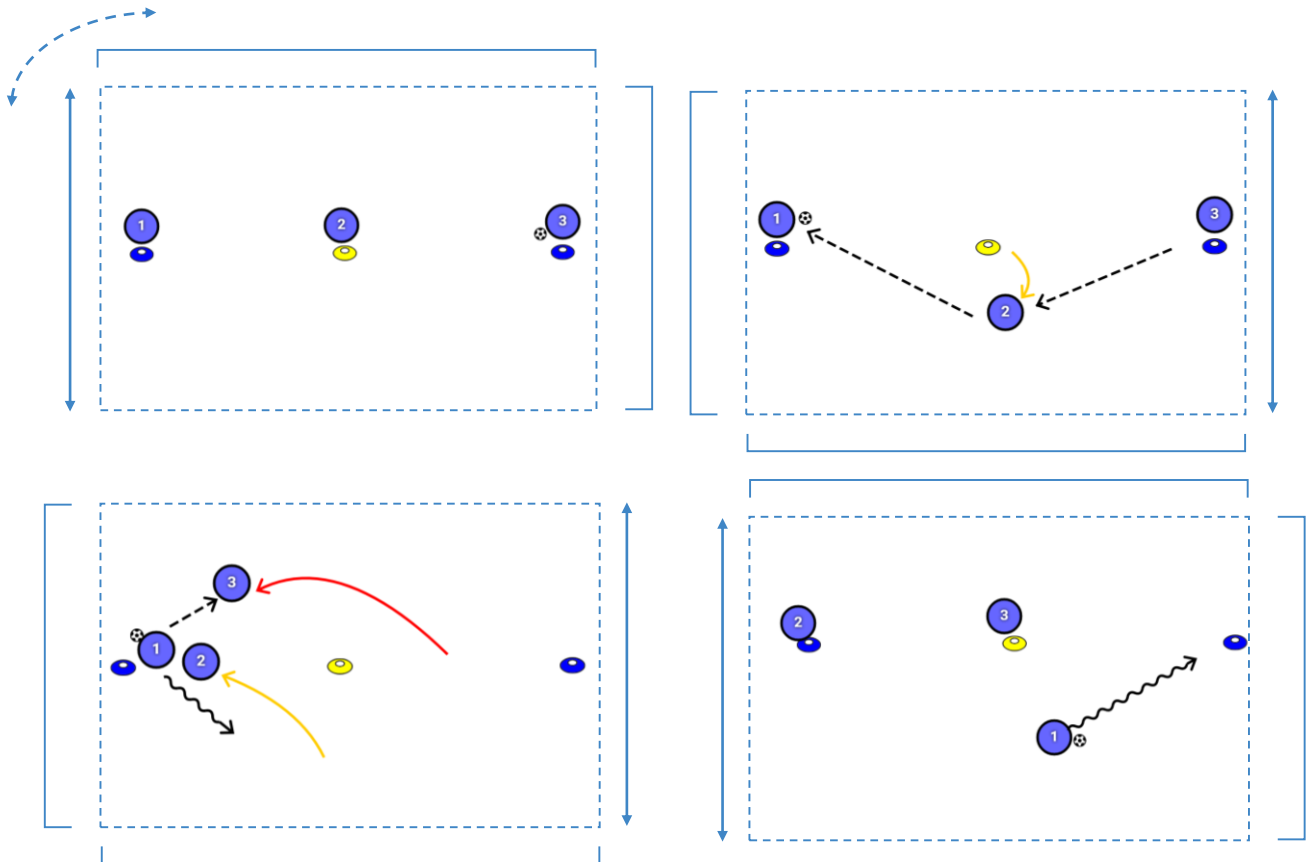
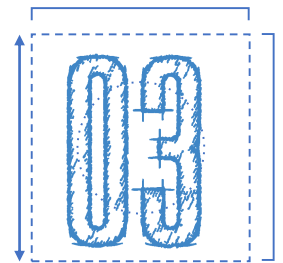
Does the player receiving the ball display disguise or a double movement to move the defender?

Receiving to turn



- # of players** The minimum group size is 2, but this practice can work with a small queue.
- organisation** The Blue player acts as a bounce player, this could also be the coach. The Yellow player starts with the ball and passes into the Blue (Top), the Blue then returns the pass (2), the Yellow player then turns out and dribbles over the end line.
- objective** In this simple practice the attacker is practicing his receiving skills to play forwards on the half turn.
- observe** Can the attacker face forward on his first touch?
Can the attacker control the ball on the move?
- progressions** In the second diagram the player is taking a touch one way and turning the other, this is to draw out the opponent and then use the space created.
- The Blue player can vary his feed to test the Yellow player, for example; hard pass, bobbly pass, chipped...etc.

1-2 or dribble?



of players Minimum group size for this practice is 3.

organisation Players working in 3's, semi-opposed but with pressure.

objective Player 2 checks away from the marker to receive the ball from player 3. Player 2 then fires the ball into player 1 and adds pressure (Picture 2 - Top Right). Player 3 supports to give player 1 the option - either dribble past player 2 or combine with player 3 in a 1-2.

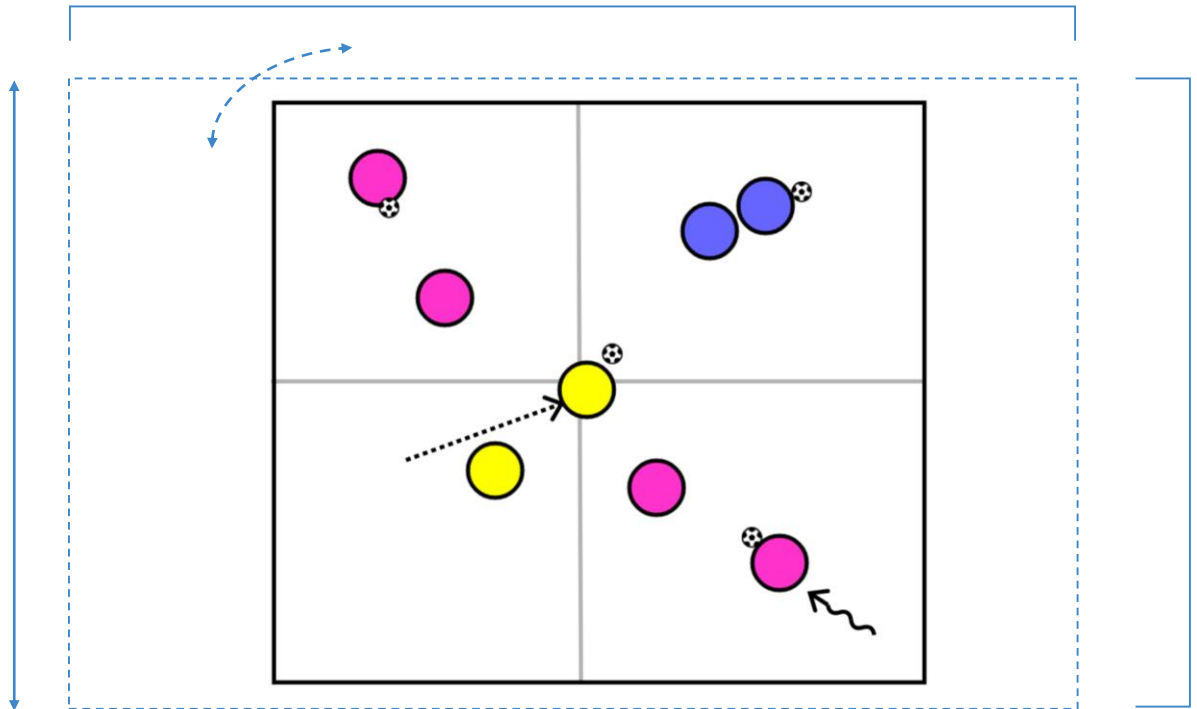
observe This practice is great for developing timing. (Picture 2-Top Right) player 2 must get his timing right to receive the ball at the correct moment. Then again (Picture 3 - Bottom Left) player 1 must decide to shift the ball and dribble or release for the 1-2 around the opponent.

The supporting angle and distance of player 3 is also really crucial, he needs to create a passing option away from the pressure of player 2.

progressions You can increase the pressure of player 2 in this practice, can he block the pass and prevent the 1-2/wall pass?

1v1 hide the ball

04



of players This practice can work with 2 players, but the more players the better...more interference and chaos for the player on the ball.

organisation Players work in pairs, with 1 ball between 2. The player in possession gets a point every time he dribbles his ball and enters a new box.

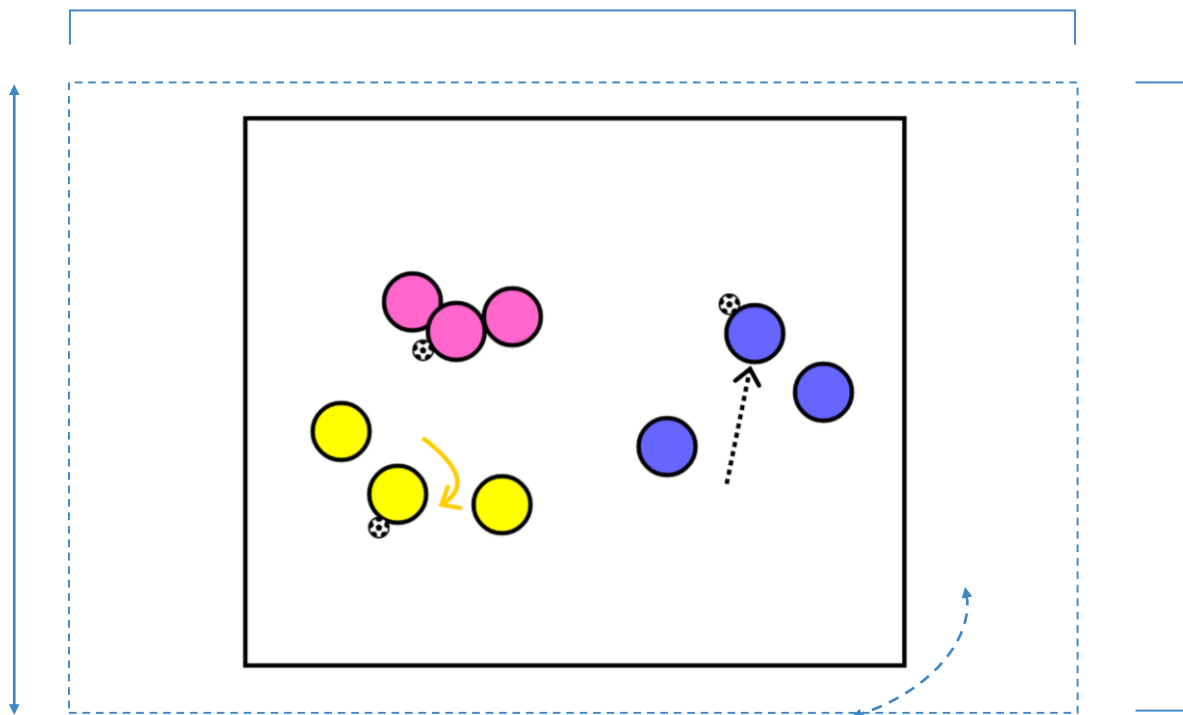
objective The objective is simple, stay on the ball and outplay your opponent.

observe This is a good practice to introduce the topic to your players, note that different players will get success in different ways. The 'solution' will be different for each individual but could include; beating your man face-to-face, using your body to shield/hide the ball or even running with the ball to utilise your pace.

progressions I usually play this game for 60 seconds rotating roles regularly. If the defender wins possession in this time the game continues but you could add target goals to add an element of transition, to encourage the regain and score!

1v2 hide the ball

05



of players Minimum group size is 3.

organisation Players work in groups of 3, with 1 ball per group.

objective This game is played for 60 or 90 seconds, one player is given the football and challenged to stay on it for duration, whilst hiding the ball from his teammates. If the defenders steal possession, the roles are reversed and the game continues.

observe This practice will be incredibly difficult for the player in possession, he will be constantly overloaded and under pressure. This will challenge the player technically, physically and psychologically.

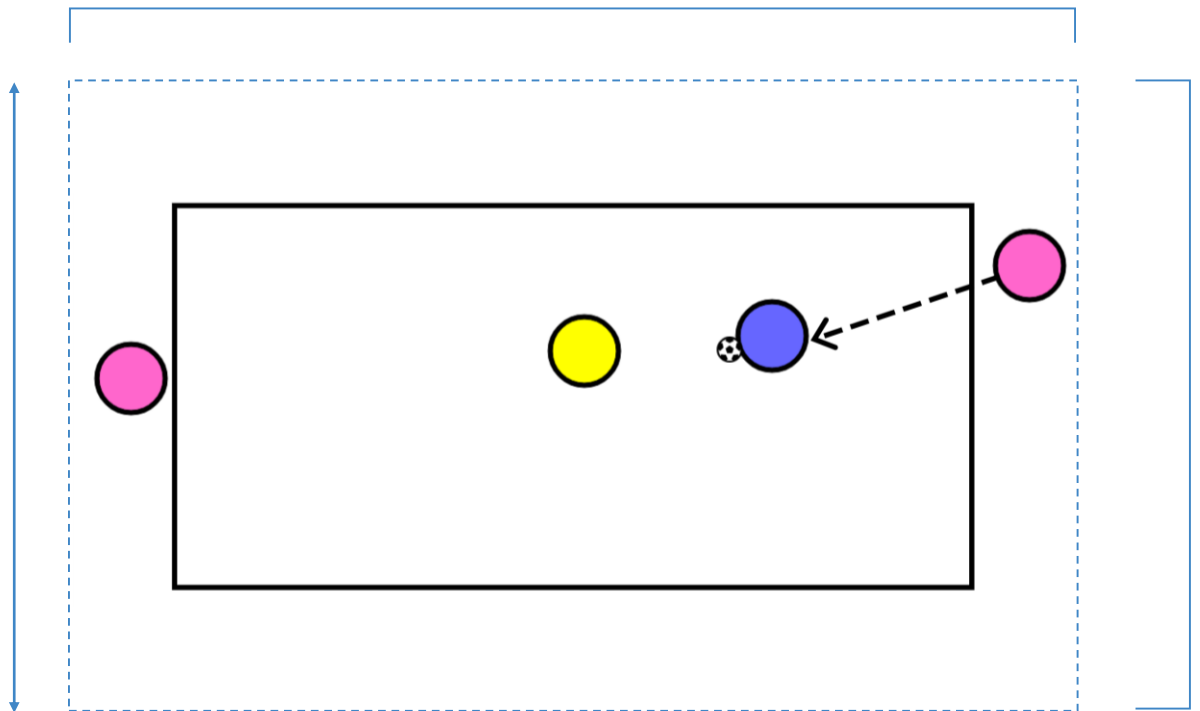
How does the player hide the ball from 2 players?
How do the players deal with adversity when they lose possession?

progressions This game can also work with 2 players, in a 1v1 scenario to get more success, but I like the challenge of 1v2.

To add an incentive for the defenders you could add target goals or gates, when they win possession they could dribble and score.

1v1 directional

06



of players Minimum group size is 4

organisation There are 2 neutral end players (Pink) with a 1v1 inside (Yellow vs Blue)

objective Players score a point by transferring the ball from one end player to another. The first to 4 points wins.

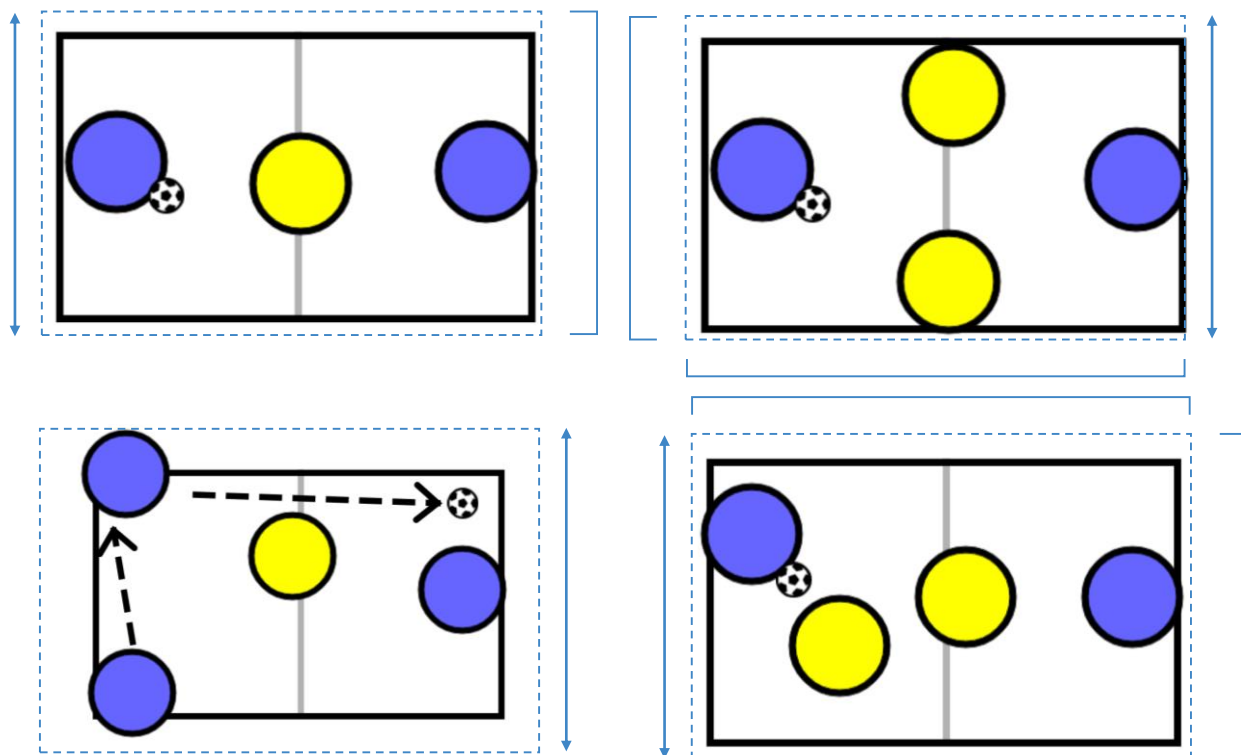
observe Movement to receive the ball.
Ability to beat the defender with variety.
Supporting position of the outside players.

progressions This simple game can be altered by manipulating the constraints;

- Limit the amount of touches the outside players can use.
- Limit the amount of touches the inside players can use.
- Alter the space, for example a long and thin pitch will encourage more forward passes and dribbling.
- Play for 90 seconds rather than first to four.
- Play 'winner stays on'.

Beat the block

07



of players Minimum group size is 3, but this session is very adaptable and can work with 4 or 5 players, as per the diagrams.

organisation Picture 1 (Top Left) shows this practice in its most simple form. The Yellow player works between two cones looking to intercept passes between the two Blue players. Picture 2 (Top Right) shows a variation, where 2 Yellow players guard the gate. In picture 3 (Bottom Left) when one of the 2 Blue players passes through, one runs to the other side to create a passing option for the man on the ball.

objective To time the release of the pass to play around the defender(s).

To stay on the ball when needed.

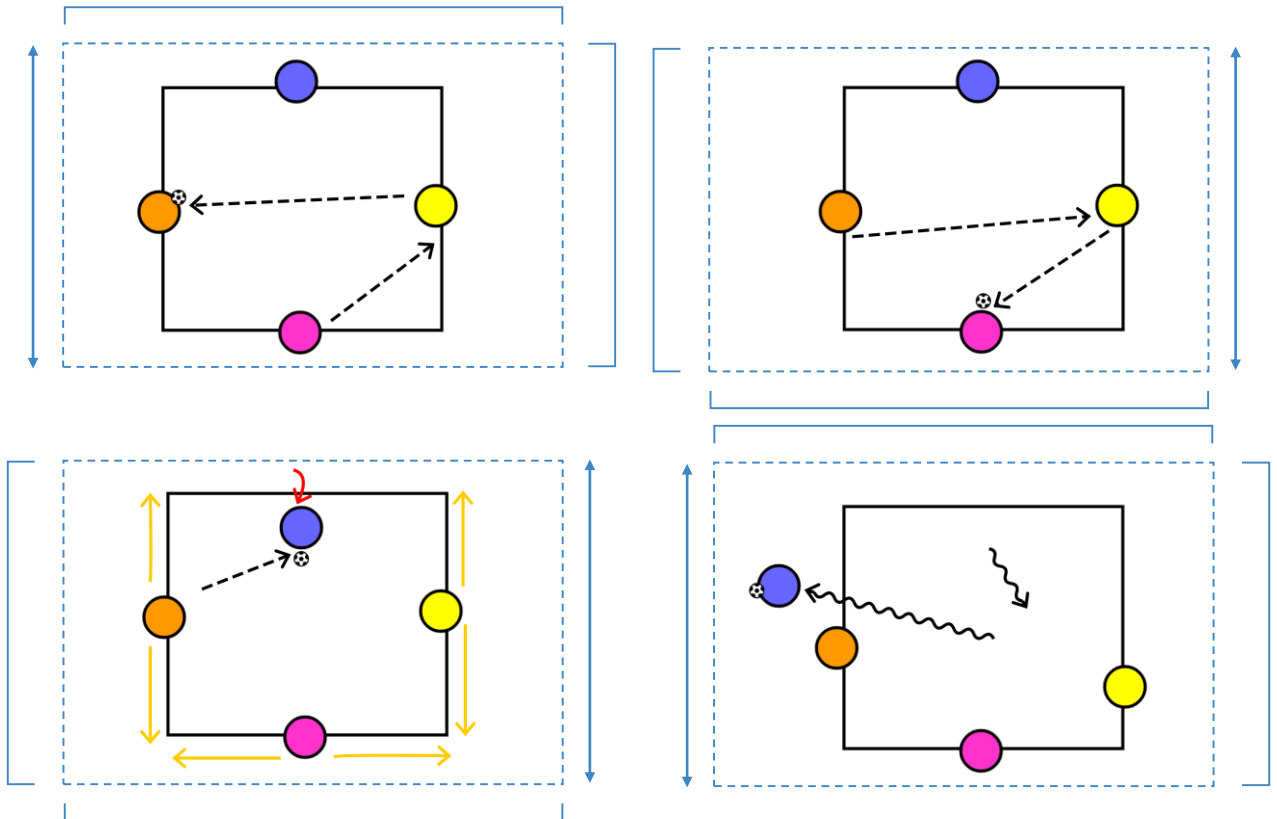
observe How can we move the defender to create an opportunity pass or dribble?

How can we support the player on the ball?

Finding the balance of when to pass and when to dribble.

progressions In picture 4 (Bottom Right) the Yellow defenders can now press, so 1 guards the line the other presses the Blue player in possession. The Blue player must now outplay his opponent and find his teammate in the opposite half.

Breakout



of players Minimum group size is 4, although this game could be adapted if you played in a different shape.

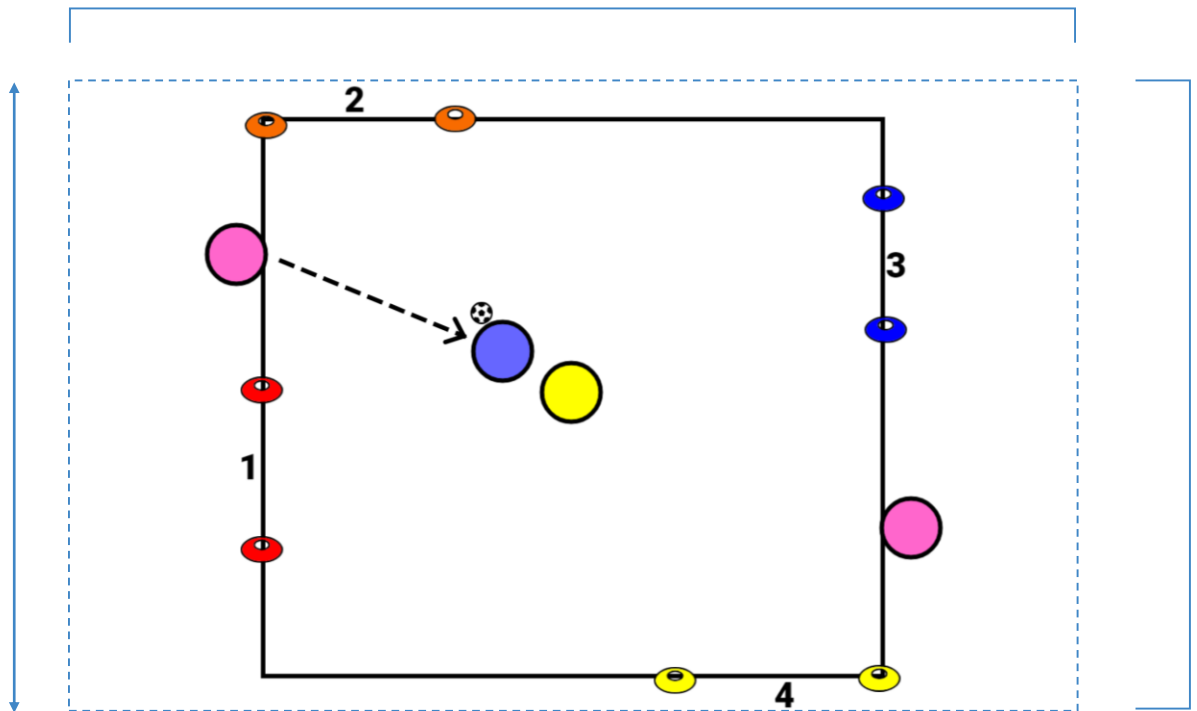
organisation Each player starts on the edge of the grid, the Orange, Yellow and Pink players make 4 passes before firing the ball into the Blue player (Picture 3). Each player now defends their line with the Blue player looking to break a line with a dribble. Rotate roles every time.

objective The objective of this practice is to beat your opponent in a face-to-face 1v1, the multi-directional element allows players to utilise feints and exit on any side of the grid.

observe The first touch here can be really important, is the Blue attacker able to exploit a gap and dribble through almost instantly? Alternatively, the Blue is in a face-to-face 1v1 where he can practice his trick or change of direction to outplay and break a line.

progressions Alter the size of the playing area.
Add a time limit.
Add target goals.

4 gate 1v1



of players Minimum group size is 4

organisation This game is a 1v1 (Blue vs Yellow), the player in possession scores by dribbling the ball through one of the 4 gates. The Pinks are neutrals but have two roles - they can be used as a bounce player to release the ball but also have 2 gates to defend.

objective To outplay your opponent and break a line with a dribble.

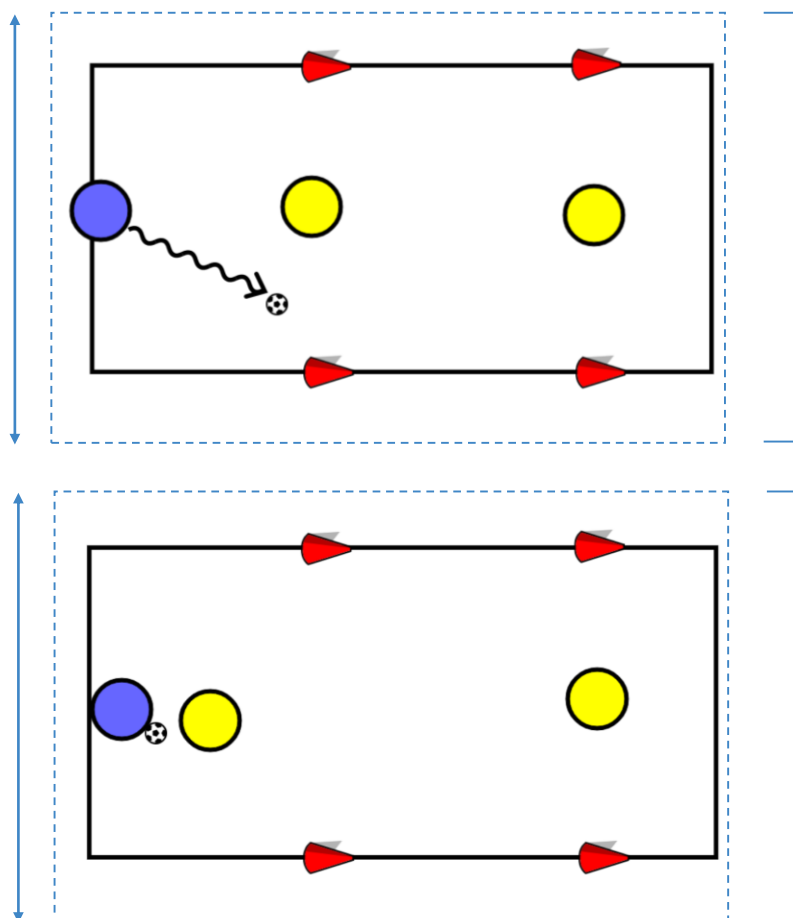
observe In possession can you scan to see which of the gates are free?

Is it most effective to dribble to the target gate or play a 1-2 with the outside Pink player?

progressions Alter the number of gates or defenders.

[Gauntlet]

10



of players Minimum group size is 3, although this practice is easily adapted to include more players

organisation The attacker (Blue) starts with the football, the defenders (Yellows) guard their coned gate looking to prevent the attacker travelling through.

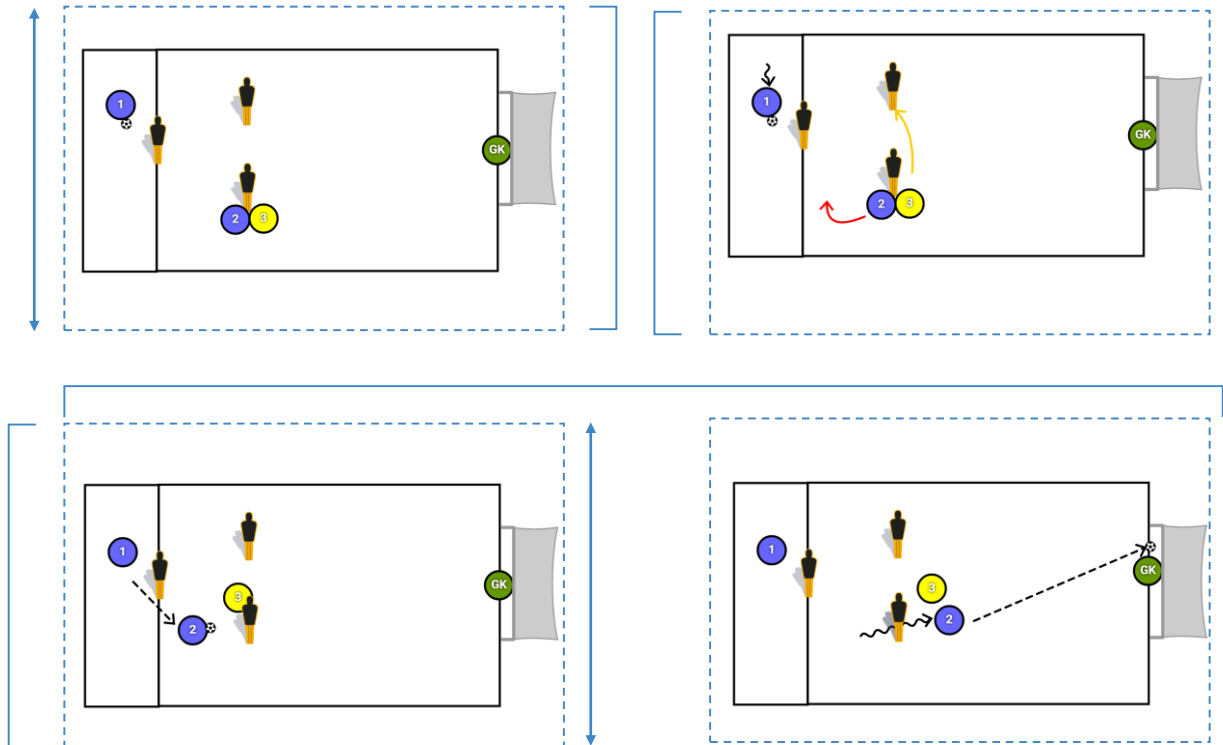
objective This practice works with the attacker (Blue) looking to dribble and beat the defenders who guard the gates Picture 1). If the defender (Yellow) tackles the attacker they swap roles and the practice continues. The attacker looks to progress from one end to the other.

observe The attacker will initially work on face-to-face 1v1's but the dynamic nature of this practice means it might turn into side-by-side or even pressure from behind, if he tries to turn and twist.

progression To progress, Yellows can come off their line and engage the attacker, rather than just guard the line as before (Picture 2).

With younger age groups add dribblers from both directions to get more success.

Movement to receive



of players This practice can work with 2 players, with the coach acting as a feeder. If you have a goalkeeper it will add realism and meaning to the 1v1.

organisation Player 1 acts as a feeder. Both the attacker (Blue) and the defender (Yellow) start stood next to the mannequin – using markers if you don't have one. The attacker (Player 2) starts the practice by moving away from the mannequin to receive the ball, the defender (Yellow) must touch one of the other mannequins (Picture 2 – Top Right) before engaging with the attacker in a 1v1 (Picture 3 – Bottom Left).

objective The attacker (Blue) looks to beat the defender inside the triangle to shoot at goal.

observe The focus is on preparation to receive the ball to play forwards – split feet, shoulders facing both the passer and target.

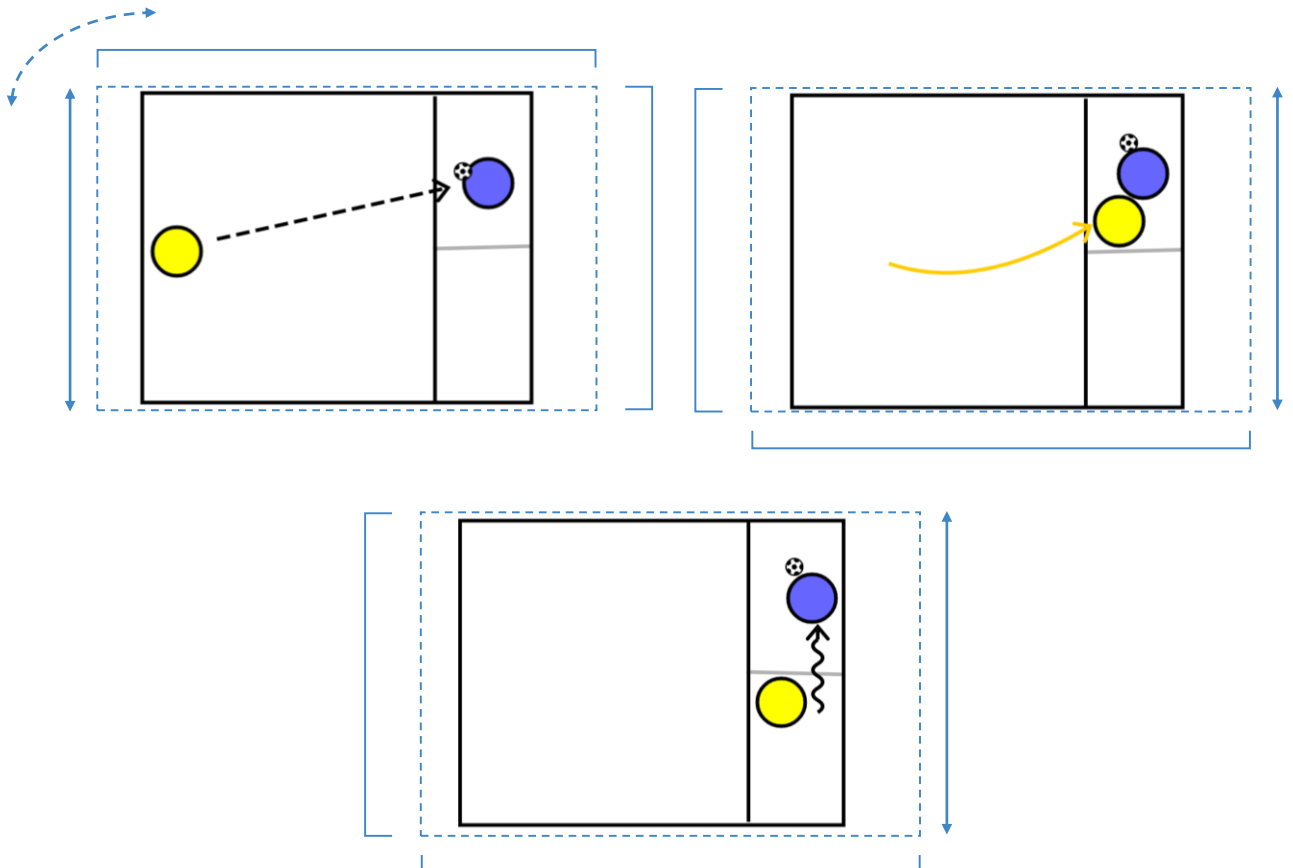
A positive touch to set yourself up for the next action, be that dribble, cut or shoot.

progressions Allow the attacker to dribble outside the triangle as well as inside.

Remove the condition that the defender must touch a mannequin – now the practice is fully opposed.

Stay on the ball

12



of players Minimum group size is 2.

organisation Two small areas with the attacker (Blue) standing in one of them. The defender (Yellow) passes the ball in and shuts down the attacker.

objective The attacker looks to hide the ball from the defender and stay on the ball, whilst staying in the small area. Once the defender regains possession the roles swap over.

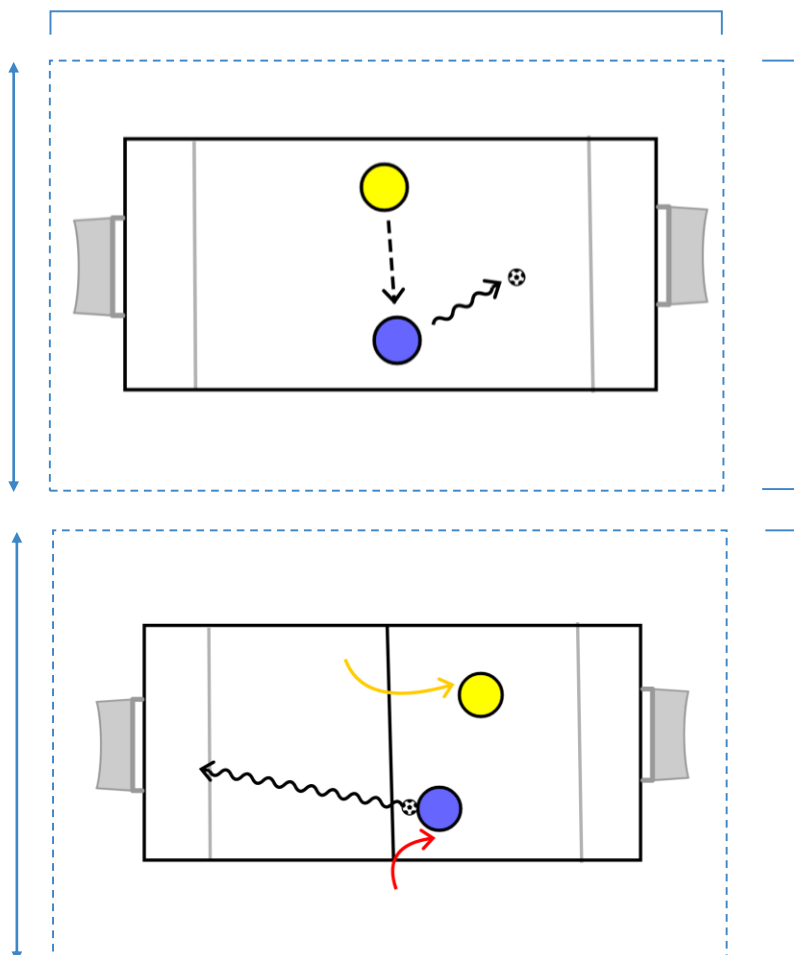
observe The attacker is encouraged to use his body to conceal the ball, often from foot to foot and placing his body between ball and defender.

progression To progress, the attacker can wriggle out of pressure and enter the second space, every time they move to a new space they score a point.

Face-to-face:

Positive touch

13



of players Minimum group size is 2, but this session can work with a small group with players rotating regularly.

organisation A small area with 2 target goals at either end. A small scoring area is present in front of each goal. The defender (Yellow) starts with the ball and passes the ball to the attacker (Blue).

objective The attacker receives the ball and looks to score in either target goal. Goals must be scored inside the scoring zone.

observe This session challenges the players in a few different ways;

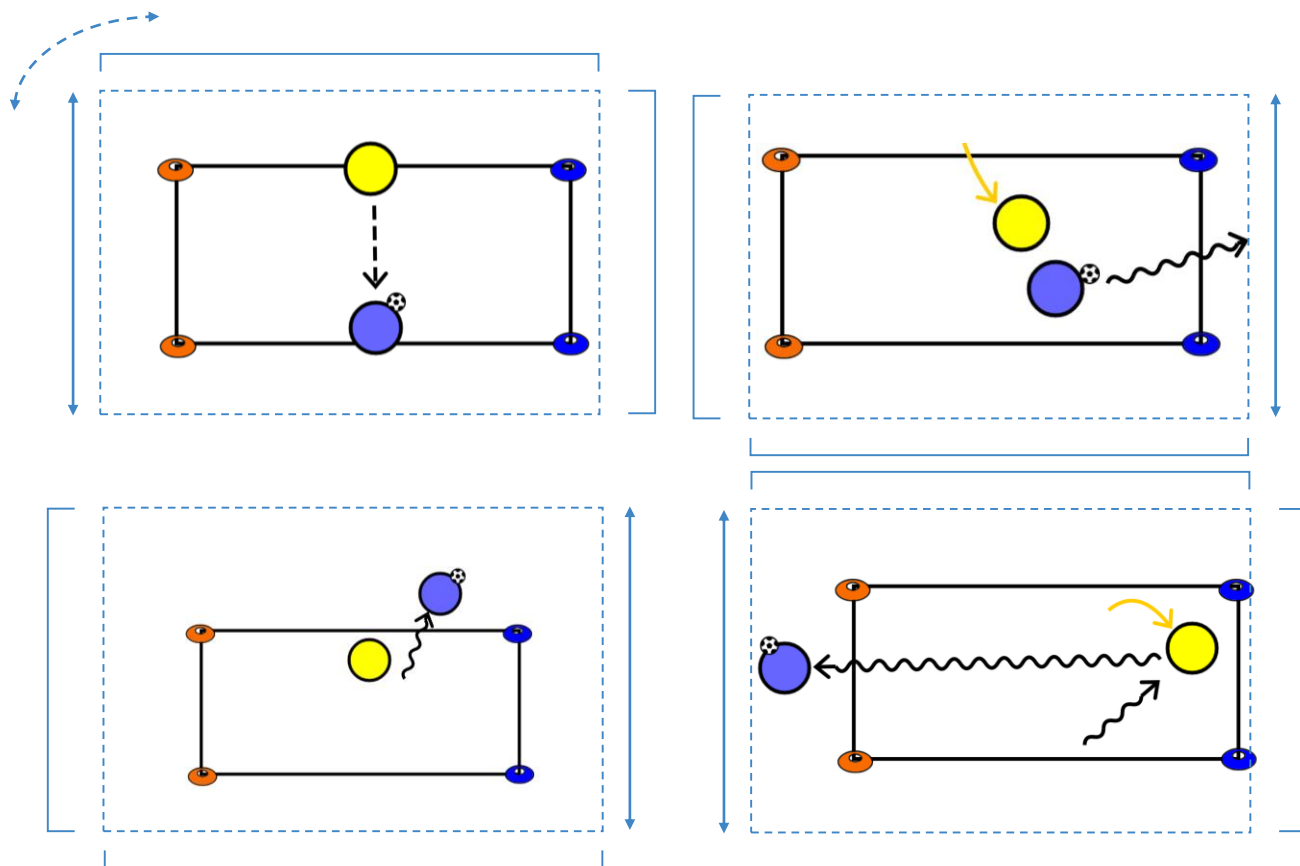
- Movement to receive the ball – can you deceive the defender with a feint or movement before you receive the ball?
- Positive touch – can you set yourself up for the next action?
- Make it count – can you outplay to win!

progression Add a halfway line, challenge the players *“Can you take the defender into one zone, turn and score in the opposite end?”*

Face-to-face:

14

Stay on the ball



of players Minimum group size is 2, but this session can work with a small group with players rotating regularly.

organisation Small area with 2 gates on either end (Orange and Blue). The attacker (Blue) receives the ball from the defender (Yellow).

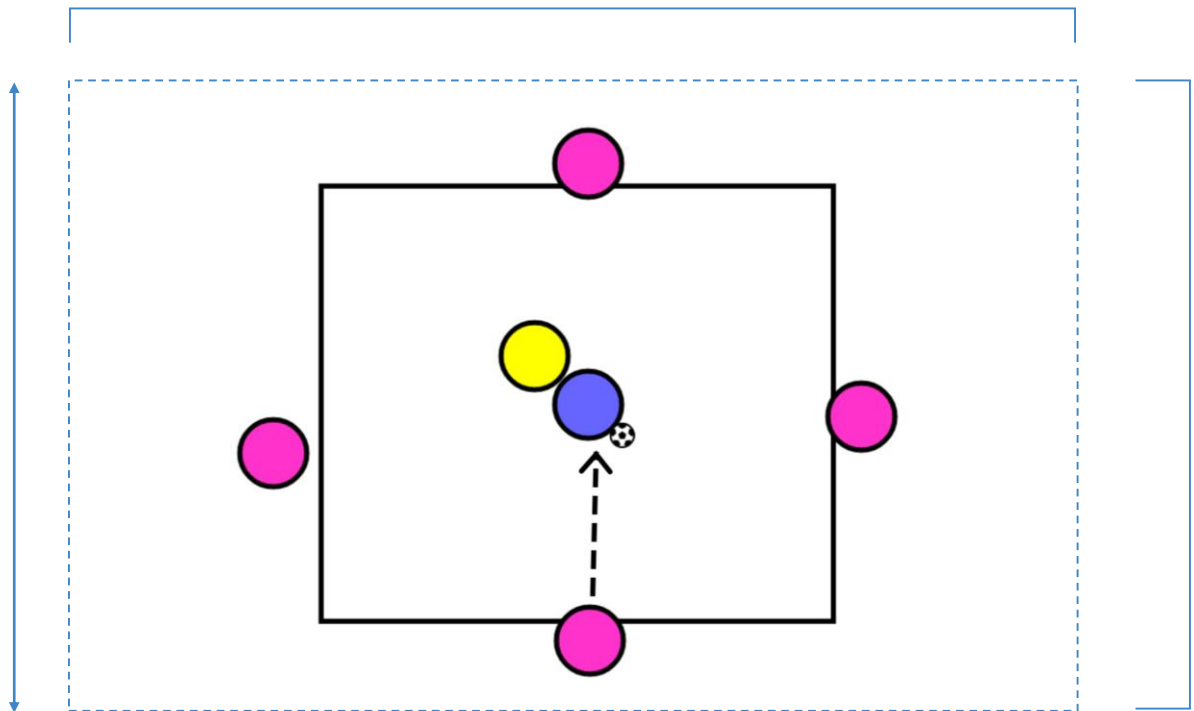
objective The objective is to exit the box through one of the 2 gates, left or right.

observe There are various ways to get success in this practice, it will look different for each individual. This might include; change of direction, use of speed, skills and power.

progressions Use the following score mechanism;

- Score through either gate = 1 point
- Score over the opposite line = 5 points (picture 3)
- Stay on the ball for 10 seconds and score = 10 bonus points

Multi-directional 1v1



of players Minimum group size is 6.

organisation A 1v1 (Blue vs Yellow) with 4 neutral players (Pink).

objective Players in the 1v1 duel look to use the outside players to eliminate and avoid the defender.

observe This practice is good to observe the players understanding of when to pass and when to dribble.

The practice is also good to challenge and develop receiving skills and body shape for the next action, under pressure.

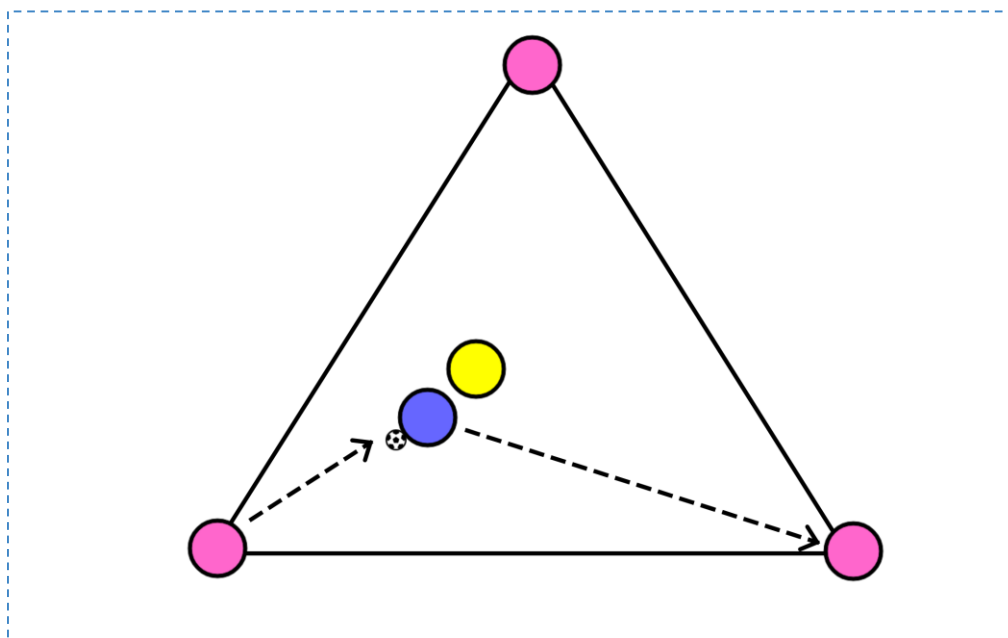
progressions Constrain the touches for the outside players.

Add a scoring mechanism, for example; first to 3 successful connections or first to visit all 4 sides of the grid.

Make the game directional, for example Blues play North to South and Yellows play East to West.

[Triangle 1v1

16



of players Minimum group size is 4.

organisation Blue vs Yellow in a 1v1, inside a triangle. At each point of the triangle a neutral player(Pink) acts as a support player.

objective The player in possession (Blue or Yellow) looks to connect passes from a Pink player, to another Pink player, the first player to 5 successful connections wins.

observe Is the player able to 'play in the future'? Can they scan - assess, adapt and execute the correct decision?

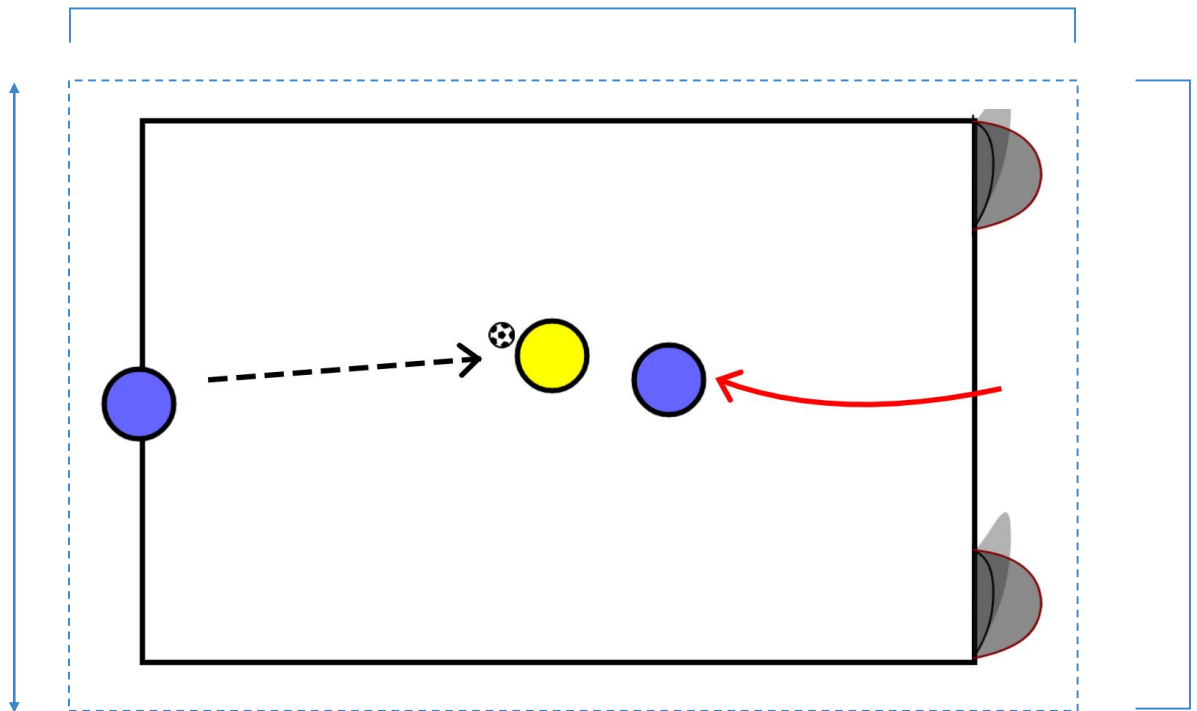
How does the attacker deal with the pressure? Does he receive safe side? Back to pressure? Face-to-face?

progressions Limit the touches of the neutral players, this will encourage the players to support incredibly quickly.

Limit the touches of the inside players (Blue/Yellow), this will encourage really quick receiving and passing - keep in mind it will remove some of the opportunities, such as dribbling or turning.

Pressure from behind 2 goals

17



of players Minimum group size is 3, but this practice can work with 4-6 players, with a few resting between repetitions.

organisation This practice builds on practice 02. The attacker (Yellow) receives the ball from the server, trying to turn and score in either target goal. The defender becomes active as the ball leaves the server's foot.

objective The attacker must receive the ball under pressure from behind.

observe Does the attacker hide the ball from the opponent using his hands, hips and bum?

How does the attacker escape the pressure, does he demonstrate variety?

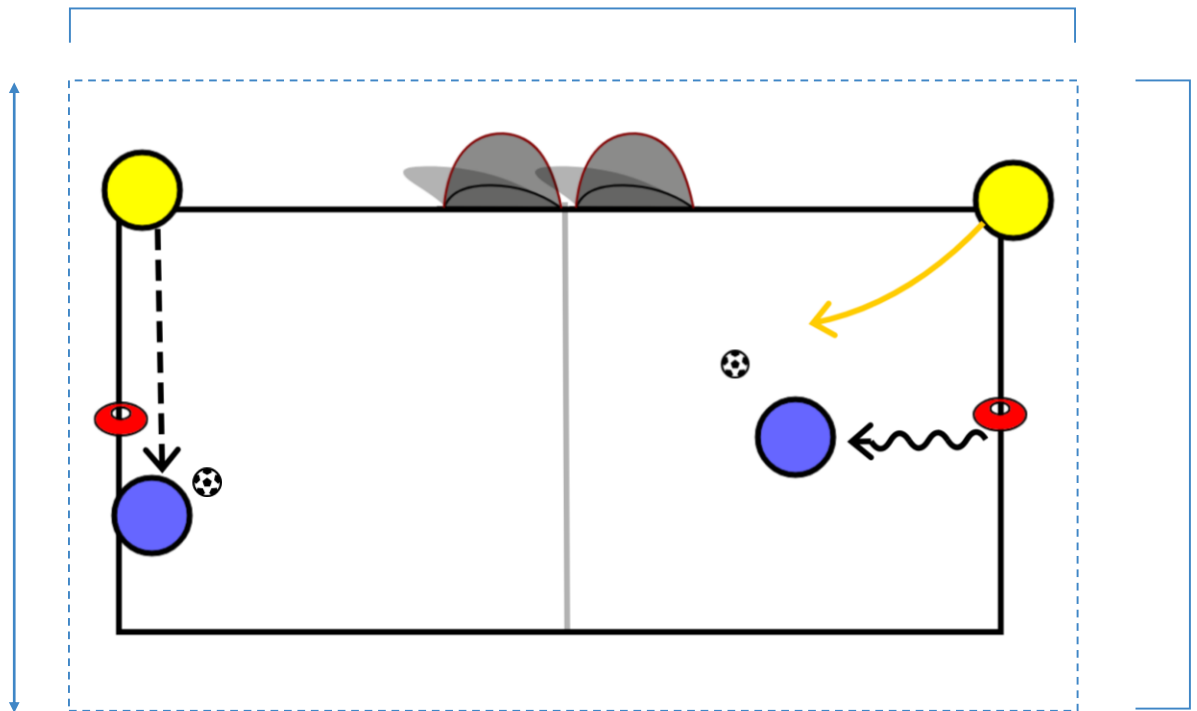
Does the player receiving the ball display disguise or a double movement to send the defender the wrong way?

progressions Add a scoring zone to encourage turning and driving at the goals, scoring within the zone.

Alternatively, create a zone 10m from the goal, but neither player can enter. This could encourage passing forwards from a realistic distance.

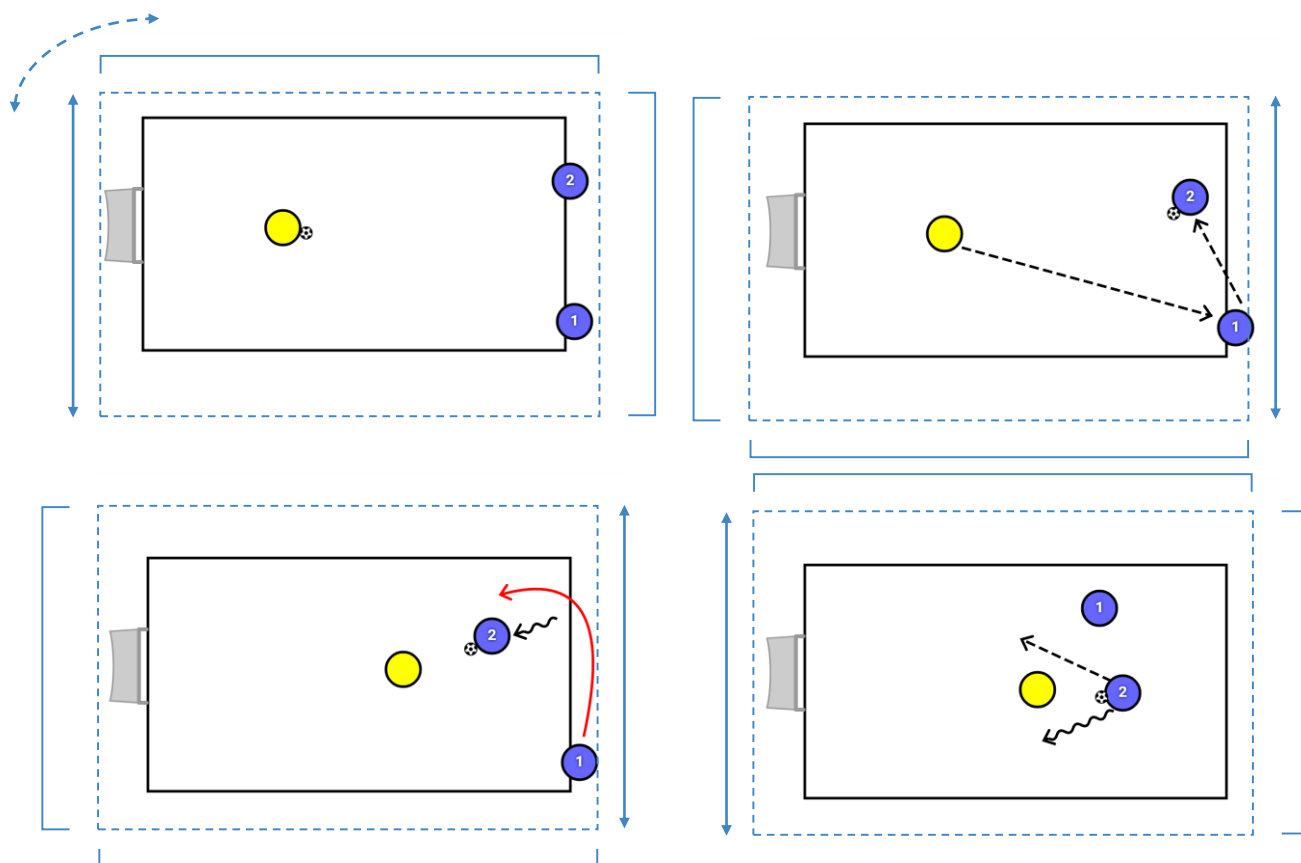
[Drive or cut]

18



- # of players** The minimum group size is 2, but this practice is quite intense so a few extra players will enable rest.
- organisation** The defender (Yellow) starts with the ball and passes to the attacker (Blue) when he makes a move off the marker. The attacker then looks to score either in the target goal or dribble over the halfway line.
- objective** This design allows the attacker to beat the defender by either outpacing with a positive touch, or alternatively playing with disguise, twisting and turning to score in the target goal.
- observe** Does the player perform comfortably on both sides (Left and Right)?
- Can the player beat the defender in different ways?
- Can the player play with disguise - feinting, changing direction or cutting the ball.
- progressions** As a progression, allow the attacker to score in either goal adding interference.
- Use flat markers to add a scoring zone to encourage more touches.

[2v1 overlap]



of players The minimum group size for this practice is 3.

organisation The defender (Yellow) starts with the ball, passing the ball to the first Blue attacker (Picture 2 - Top Right). Player 1 plays a square pass to Player 2 and overlaps (Picture 3 - Bottom Left). The attackers then look to score in the target goal.

objective This practice challenges the players on when and how to use the overload, with the objective to eliminate the defender and score.

observe Timing of the release to create a finishing opportunity.

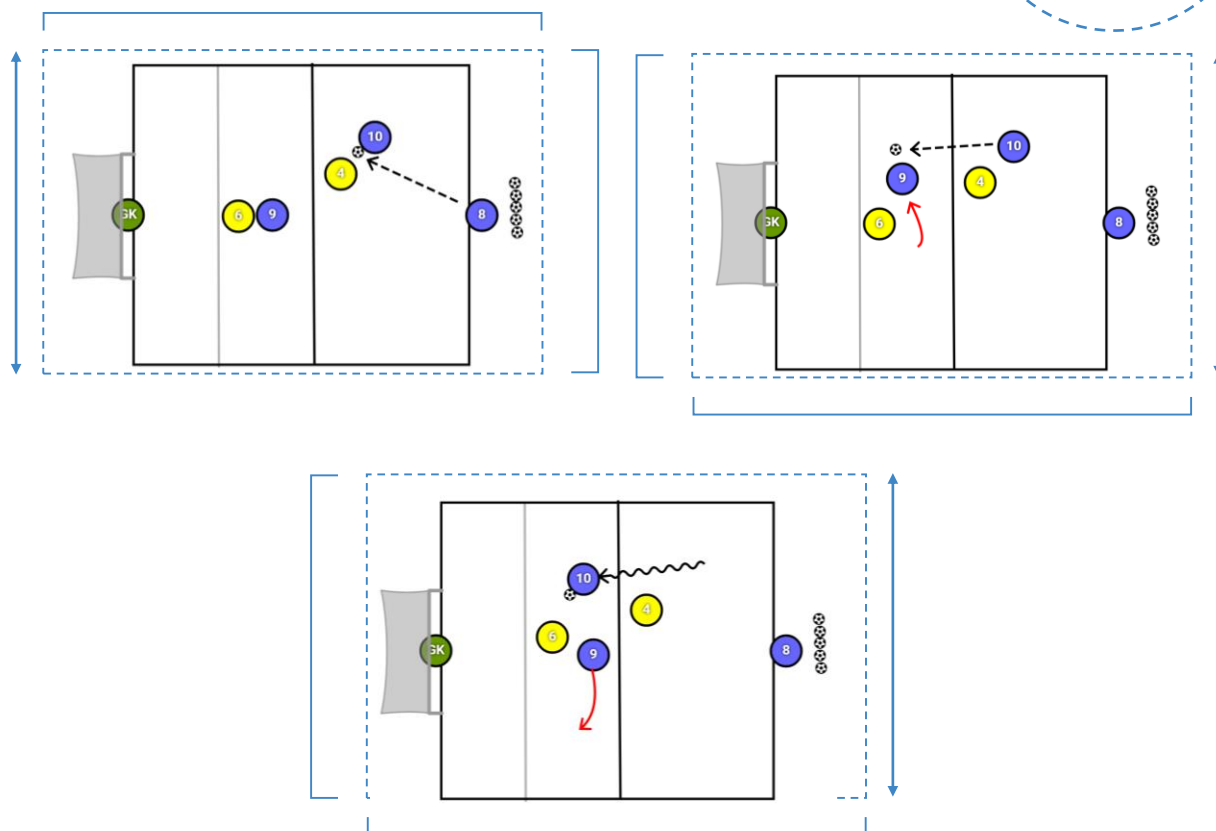
When to pass and when to dribble?

Do not miss the opportunity to play forwards (penetration)?

progressions To add more challenge, add a 1-touch finish. This will also zoom on the weight of pass from the assister to enable a 1-touch finish.

Outplaying as #9 and #10

20



of players In this practice the minimum group size is 5. This practice can be easily adapted to create overload or underload situations.

organisation Blues are attacking the large goal, Yellows acts as the defenders. The #8 (Blue) starts the practice by playing into #10 who is matched up in a 1v1 in the first area. The #9 (Blue) is also matched up in a 1v1 in a second area. Offsides occur after the grey line in this practice.

objective In this practice the Blue #10 looks to outplay his opponent, passing the ball into the #9 and joining to create a 2v1 scenario.

observe How does the #10 outplay his man, whilst being able to supply the #9?

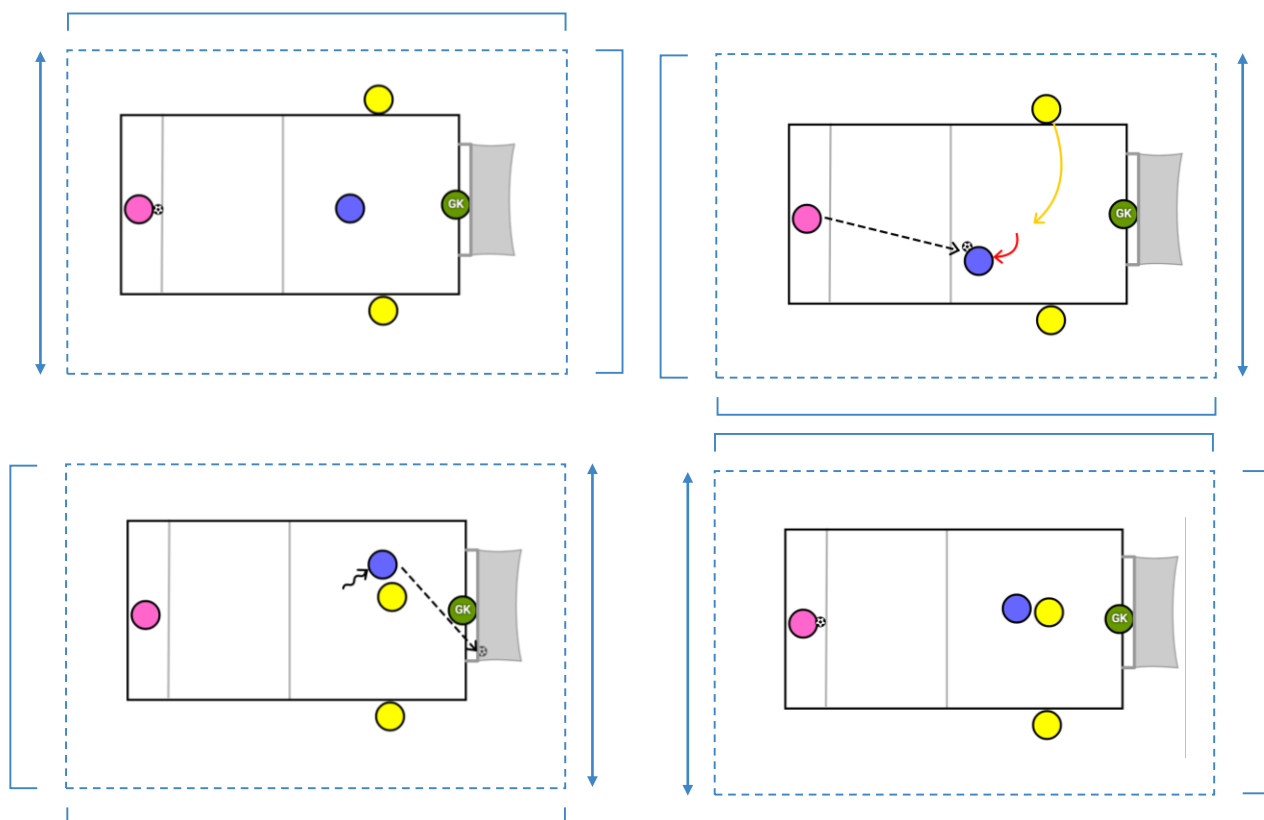
Does the #9 pin and role or move into space?

How do the 2 attackers utilise the overload situation to get a shot on target?

Progressions #8 can play directly into the #9.

Yellow #4 can recover and track back.

Turn and shoot



of players Minimum group size is 4 plus a goalkeeper if available.

organisation The Pink player acts as a server and passes into the attacker (Blue), as soon as the ball is live one defender (Yellow) presses from outside the area. The attacker must receive the ball in the opposition half to encourage a realistic distance of pass from the server.

objective This practice will have lots of variability with the defender offering pressure from different angles and distances. This will challenge the attacker to scan and adapt quickly to the type of 1v1 that the defender creates.

observe Does the attacker receive the ball facing forwards or is his body shape closed?

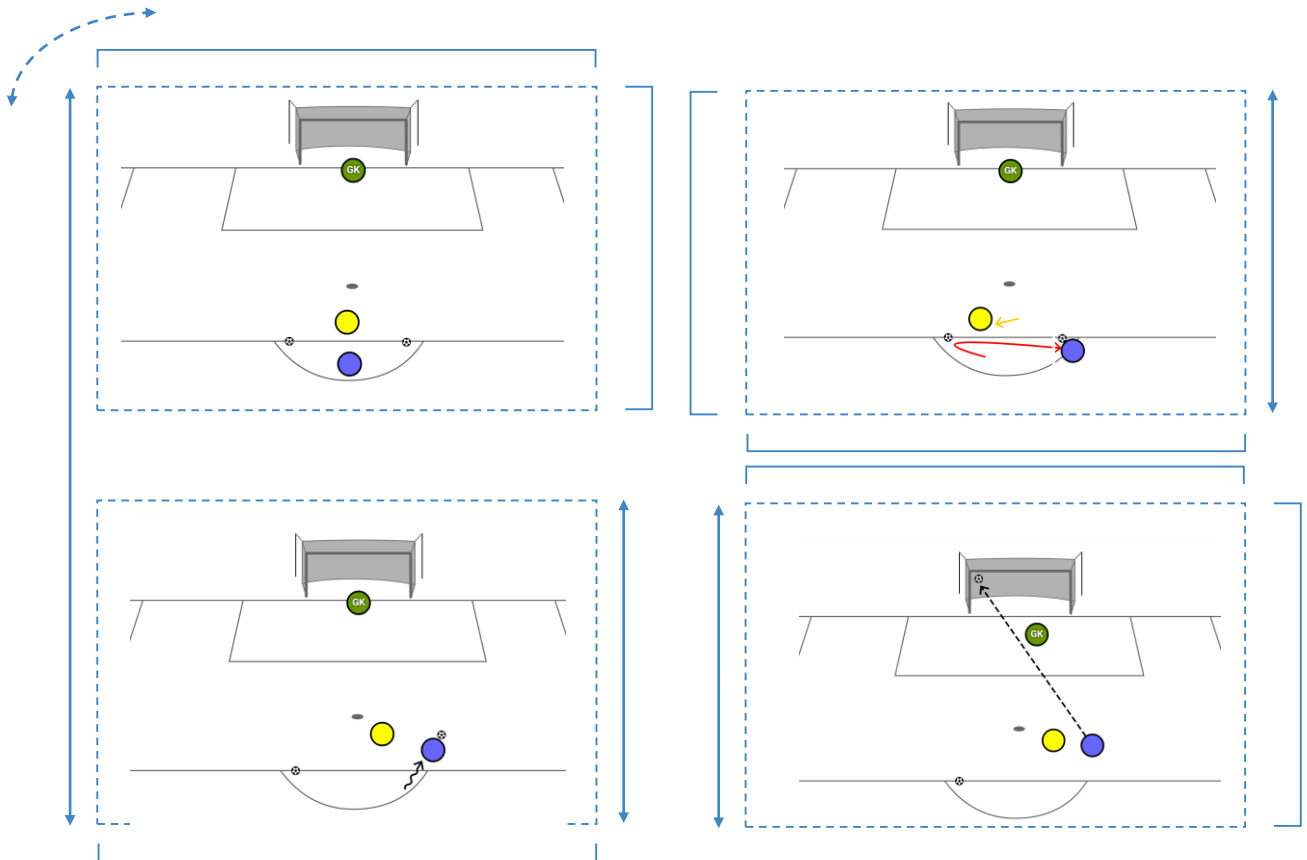
Can the attacker manipulate the space to play to his strengths? (speed, change of direction, trick).

Can the attacker beat the defender on both sides and finish with either foot?

progressions To progress this session start with the defender inside the space.

2 ball fake and finish

22



of players Minimum group size is 2 outfield players and a goalkeeper if available.

organisation The 2 players start face to face, with 2 football's placed at the top of the penalty box.

objective The aim for the attacker (Blue) is to take 1 of the 2 footballs and score past the keeper. The defender (Yellow) can only mirror the attackers movement and is not 'live' until the ball has been touched. The practice encourages the attacker to use feints and changes of direction to put the defender off balance and create an advantage.

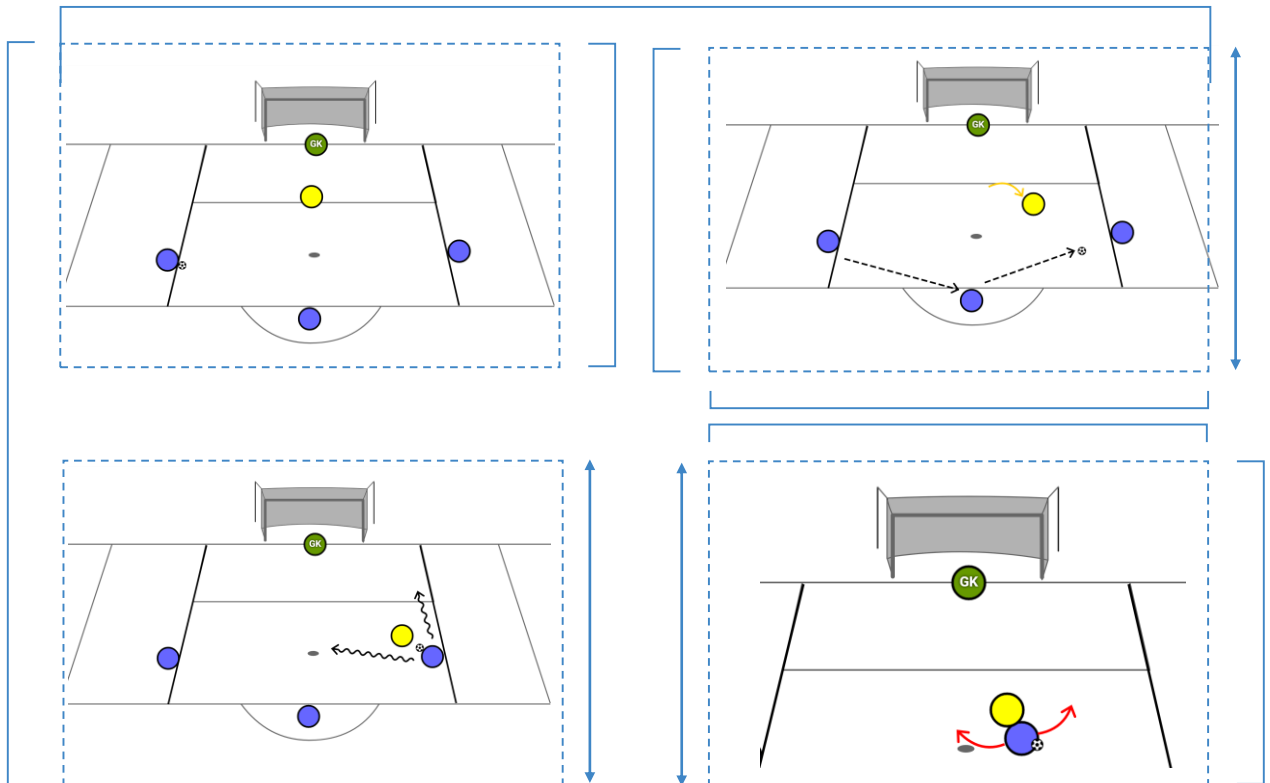
Note: The attacker must take a touch before shooting, otherwise he is able to remove the 1v1 element of this practice.

observe Does the attacker move the defender with short and explosive movements to unbalance his opponent?

When the attacker takes the football is he able to beat the defender on 'both sides' and shoot with either foot?

Finish under pressure

23



of players This practice is very adaptable, in this example there are 4 outfield players and 1 goalkeeper.

organisation The defender (Yellow) starts centrally protecting the goal. The 3 attackers (Blue) start on the outside of the grid, this can be altered for different outcomes.

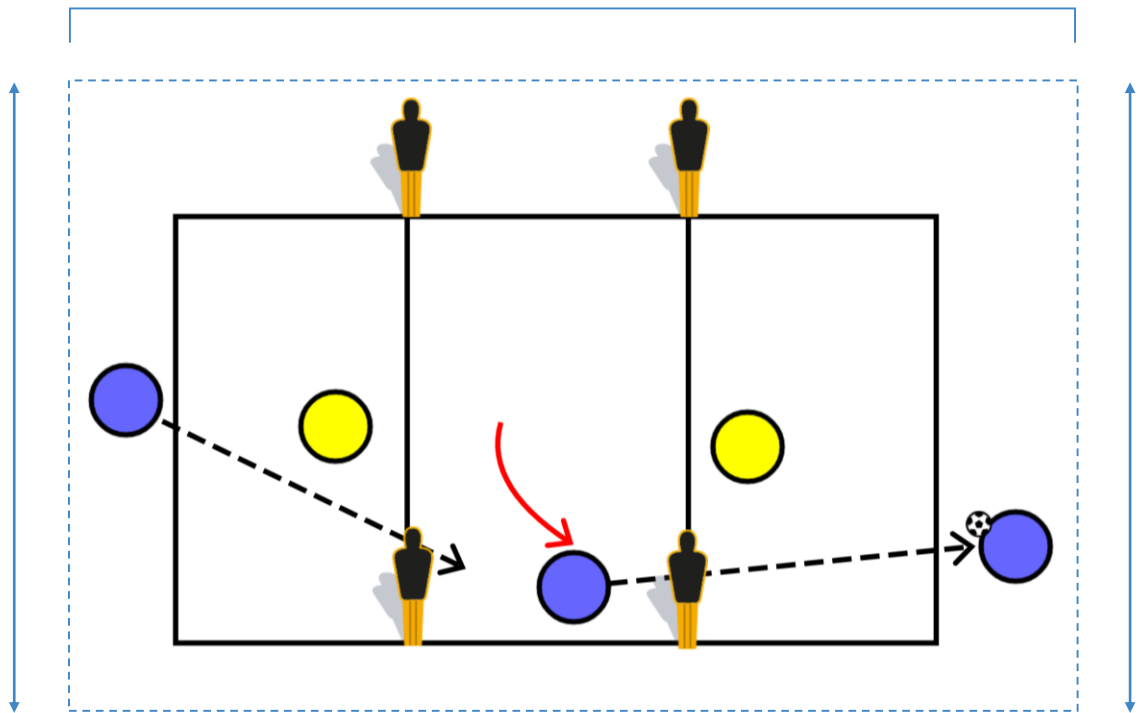
objective This practice can be used in a few different ways. The Blues play a number of passes before any forward chooses to attack the goal. Alternatively, the coach can choose one of the positions to be the player that attacks to shine a light on more specific finishes. In the diagrams above the player on the right side takes the ball and looks to take the defender in a 1v1 situation.

observe Can the forward manipulate the defender to create the shooting opportunity he desires?

When the attacker receives the football is he able to beat the defender on 'both sides' and shoot with either foot?

Receiving between the lines

24



of players This practice works best with 5 players. It can be adapted so more players play in the central area, or multiple groups of 3 play in the same space.

organisation A twist on a traditional passing and receiving drill. The central midfielder works in a central strip is looking to receive the ball from the server and pass the ball to the opposite end.

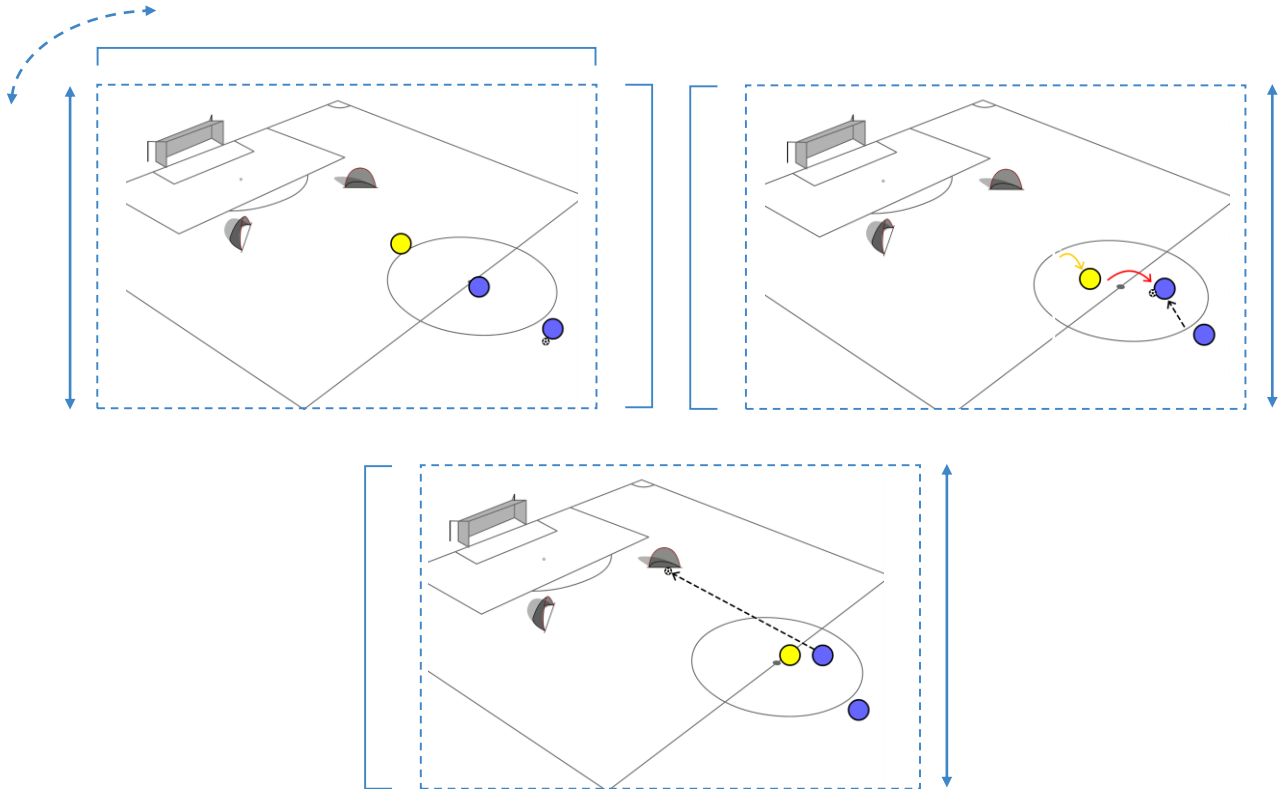
objective The defenders (Yellow) looks to screen and intercept passes into the central midfielder. The midfielder is getting repetition of receiving to play forwards.

observe Does the midfielder take up and adjust his position to receive the ball on the half turn, to play forwards quickly?

progressions Allow the Yellow to press from behind once the ball enters the central zone.

Remove all zones and play 1v2 in the central area...this will be tough!

Playing through 360°



of players The minimum group size for this practice is 3.

organisation Two target goals set up either side of the box, these can be moved to add more variability, and paint different pictures for the midfielder. The attacker (Blue) looks to receive the ball, turn and pass into the target area. The defender (Yellow) adds pressure from behind.

objective The intent of this practice is to improve the attackers ability to receive the football and play forwards. The pressure from behind replicates a player receiving in a pocket of space, and is perfect for midfielders.

observe Does the attacker receive the ball on the correct foot to play forwards?

Does the attacker 'scan' to see the defender?

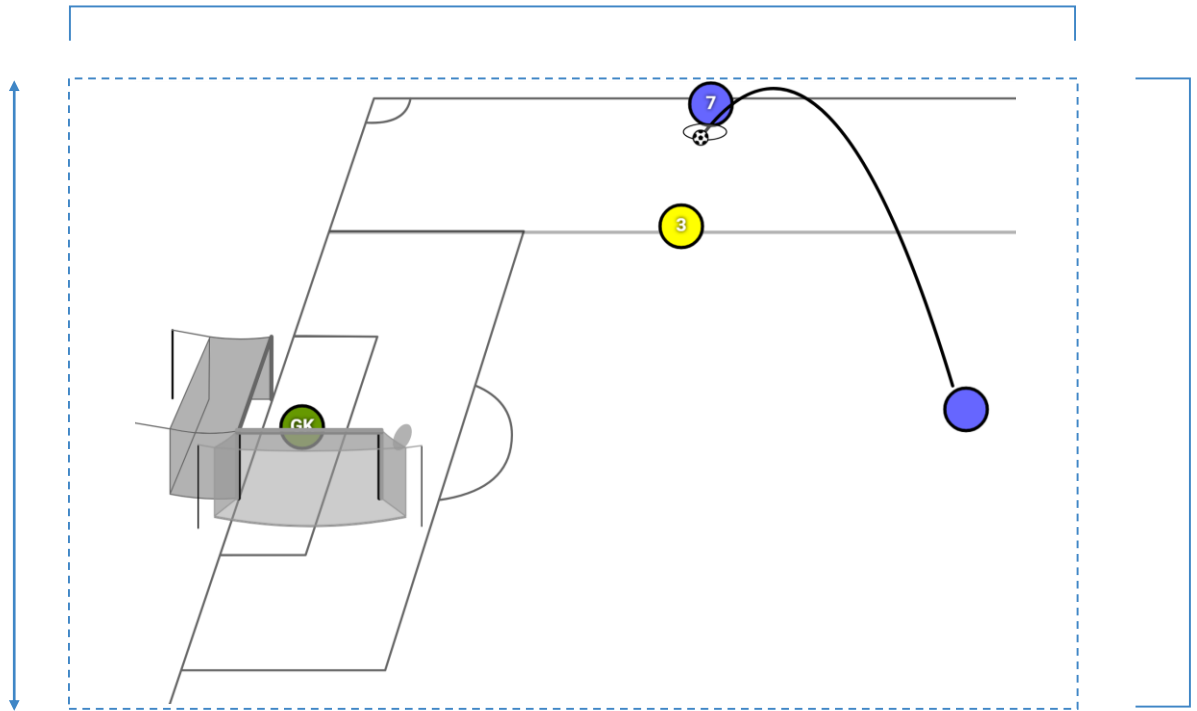
Does the attacker have the ability to play forwards off 2-3 touches or does he choose to dribble?

progressions Play with the defender (Yellow) man marking the attacker.

Alter the space, touches or time the attacker has to play forwards.

Beat the man out wide

26



of players Minimum group size is 3 plus a goalkeeper if available.

organisation The attacker (Blue #7) standing in the wide zone receives the ball from the server. The defender (Yellow #3) pressures the attacker from the side.

objective The attacker looks to beat the Full Back on the inside or outside and finishes with a cross or shot. If shooting, the attacker looks to score past the goalkeeper in the main goal, the other goal is a target for a cross.

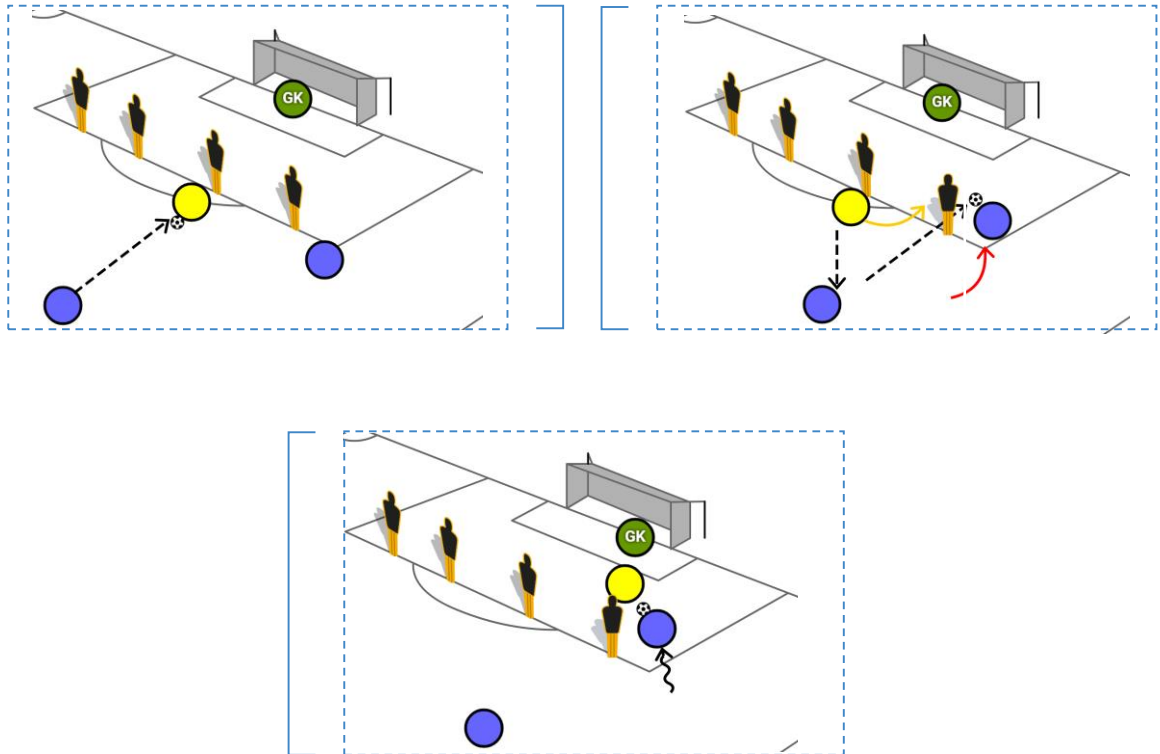
observe How does the attacker's first touch set him up for the next action? Large touch to beat the man with pace or a tight touch to dribble.

Is the attacker able to beat the defender on both sides?

progressions Manipulate the starting position of the Full Back to alter the amount of pressure the winger receives.

This practice can be built up to include more players, perhaps a striker or even replicate the practice on both sides.

Winger inside



of players This practice can work with a minimum of 3 players with a goalkeeper if available.

organisation The Yellow (Defender) starts in a central position to replicate a Central Defender. The winger (Blue) starts in a wider position and will attack the box from the angle, to replicate a Winger running from outside to in.

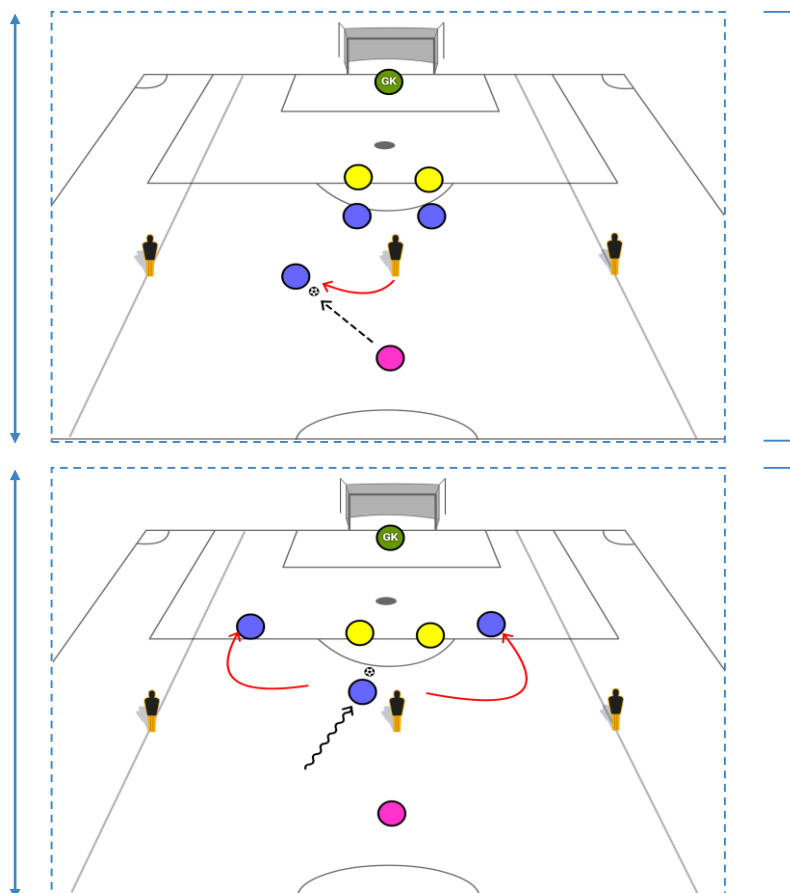
objective The first attacker acts as server, this could also be the coach if numbers are low. The server plays the ball into the Yellow before sliding a through ball for the Winger between mannequins. The Yellow now makes a recovery run to add pressure on the forward.

observe Can the Winger demonstrate effective timing to stay onside, but also maintain the superiority over the defender?

Does the Winger finish early or does he cut back across the goal?

This practice will allow lots of repetition of finishes from this angle, this might include; curled, driven, near post, far post...etc

Overload in the final third



of players This practice uses 3 Blue attackers against 2 Yellow defenders, with 1 goalkeeper. The server (Pink) could be the coach. This practice can be adapted to suit different numbers.

organisation The 2 attackers (Blue) are matched up against 2 defenders (Yellows) in a central area. The practice starts with the Blue player moving off the mannequin to receive the ball from the server, it is now into a 3v2 scenario, attack versus defence.

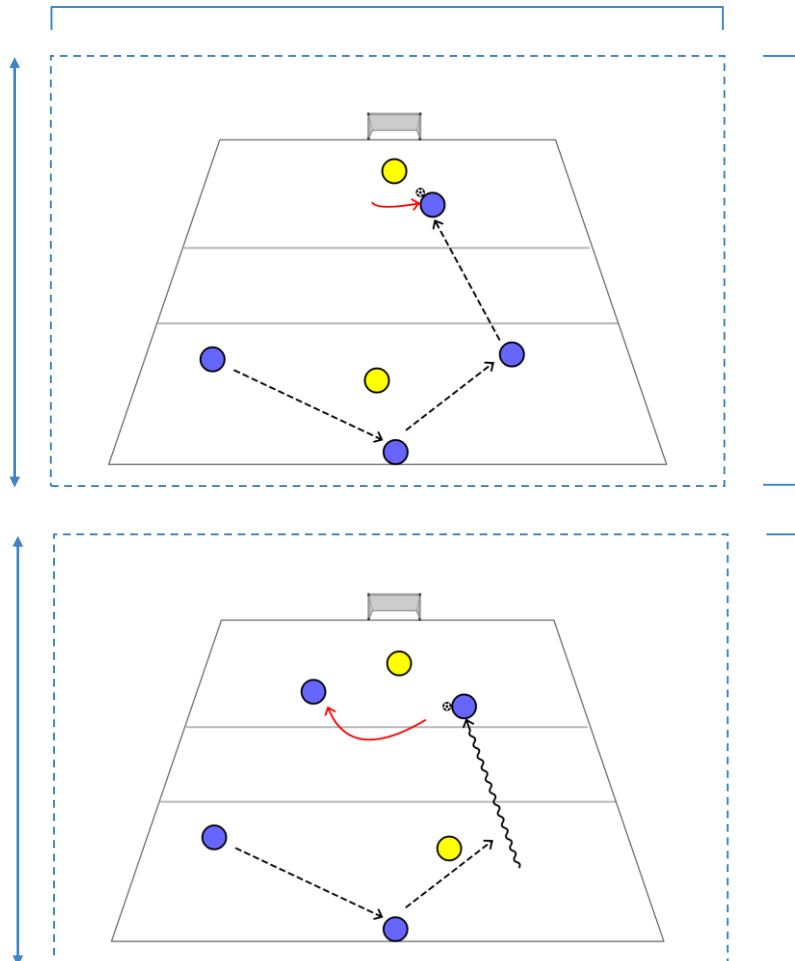
objective This practice is designed to re-create an attacking overload in the final third.

observe The individual on the ball will have several different decisions to consider;

- Does he dribble and supply one of his teammates?
- Does he dribble and shoot?
- If he releases, the timing is crucial to eliminate the defender.
- When dribbling, how does he draw the defenders out of shape?

Progressions Alter the numbers to alter the challenge (overload/underload). Start the practice fully opposed to challenge receiving and playing forwards under pressure.

3v1 breakout



of players This practice can be adapted to suit numbers, in this version we have 6 players.

organisation The area is split into 2 halves with a central "no go" area. The bottom box has a 3v1 situation in favour of the attackers (Blue), with a 1v1 in the top area. The Blues are looking to score in the target goal.

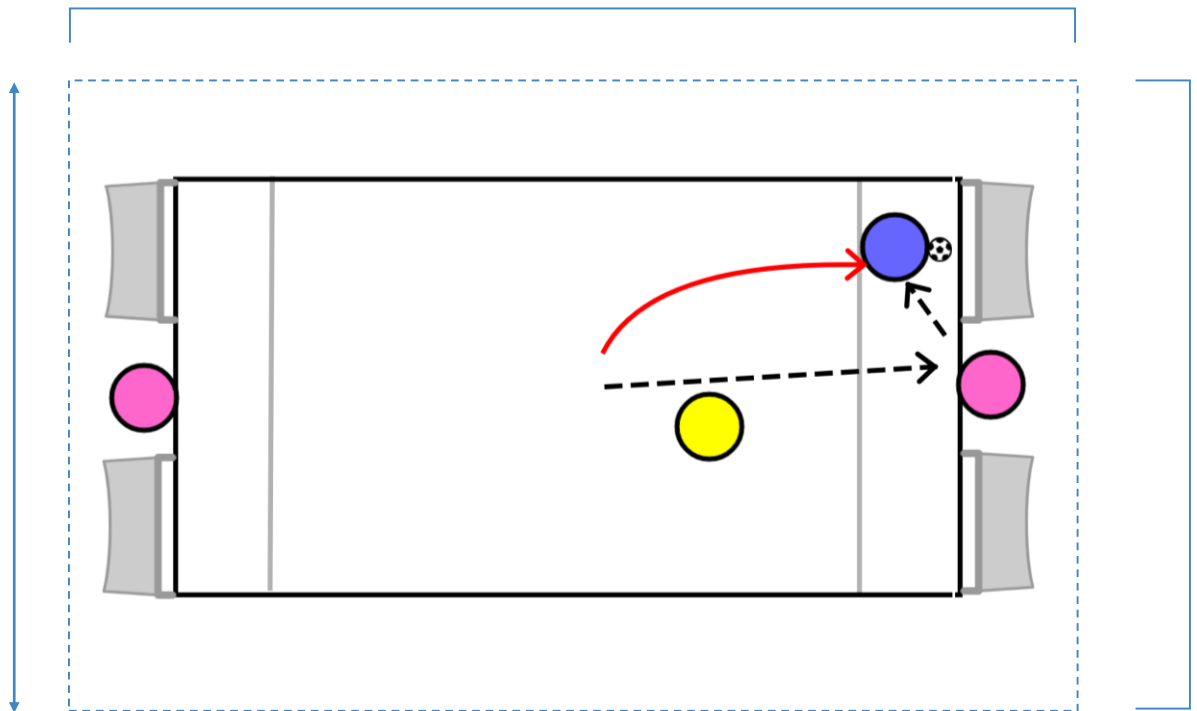
objective In the first diagram the 3 players look to combine to play into the Blue forward, with 1 player supporting to create a 2v1 situation. For a different focus, as shown in diagram two, the Blues must run with the ball to create the 2v1.

Progressions A few tweaks can challenge the players technically and tactically, some examples could include;

- Can you get out of box one on your first touch?
- Can you score with a 1-touch finish in box two?
- Allow the Yellows to make recovery runs.

Four goal game 1v1

30



of players This game works with 4 players.

organisation This game is a 1v1 (Yellow vs Blue) with 2 neutral players (Pink) playing at either end. 4 target goals are used, with a small scoring zone formed using cones or flat markers.

objective The Blue/Yellow players must outplay and score within the scoring zone. Rotate roles regularly, either playing first to 3 or 2 minute matches.

observe This game will produce lots of random learning outcomes, including:

When to dribble?

When to pass?

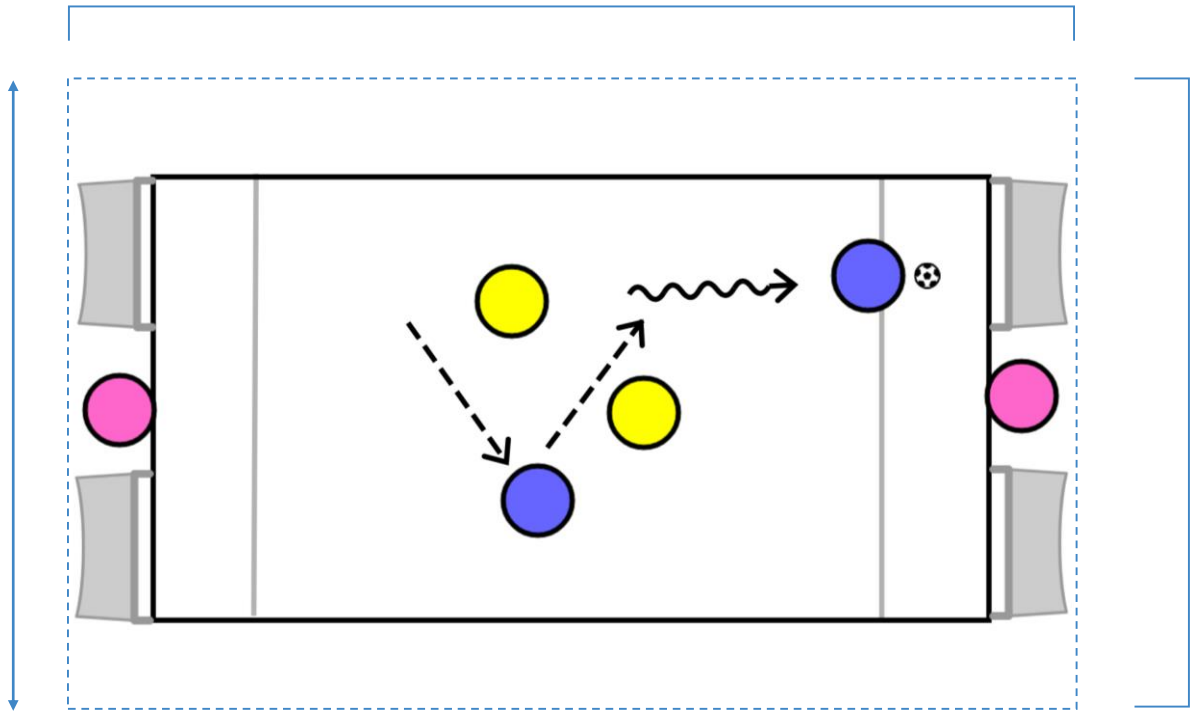
Playing to your strength - face to face, hide, pace, pass?

Adapting your game to your opponent, is he quicker, stronger...etc?

progressions Limit the neutral players to 1 touch to encourage faster support play.

3 team 2v2

31



of players This game works with 6 players and is a progression of practice 30, increasing the complexity.

organisation This game is a 2v2 (Yellow vs Blue) with 2 neutral players playing either end. 4 target goals are used, with a small scoring zone formed using cones or flat markers.

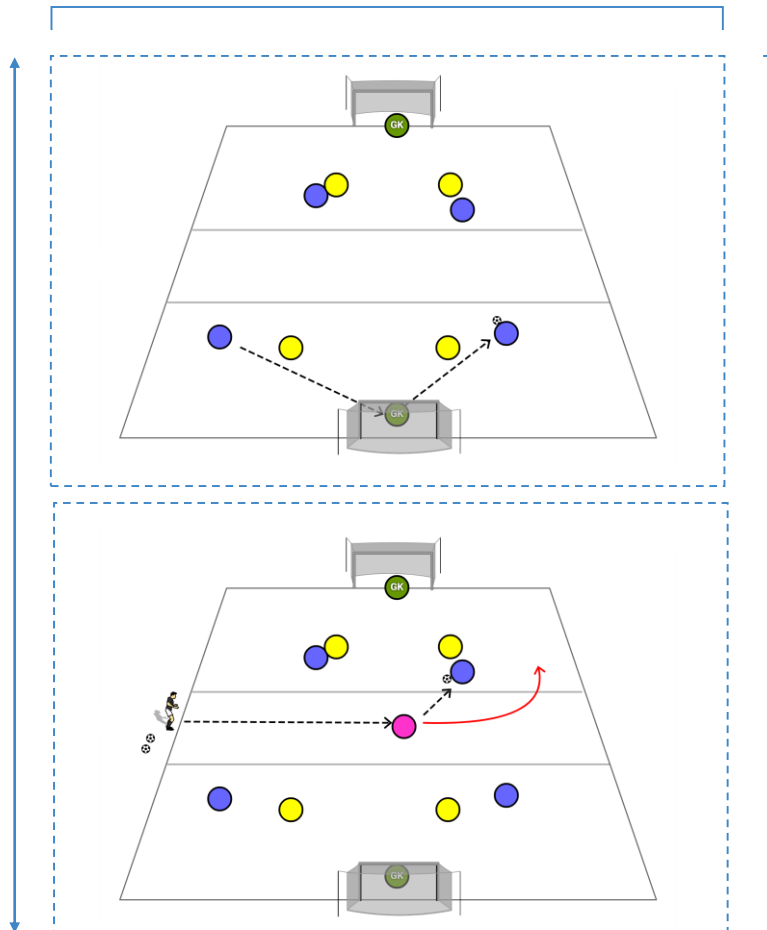
objective The Blue/Yellow players must outplay or combine and score within the scoring zone. Rotate roles regularly, either playing first to 3 or 2 minute matches.

observe This game is one of the players' favourite, the 2v2 creates a more game-like situation, whereby they can pass, dribble or play direct into the end man and make a forward run.

When in possession, its important to support alongside or in front, generally there is no need to support from behind as the man on the ball can restart by playing back to the Pink neutral player.

progressions I like to play with this constraint "If you use the Pink it must be a 1 touch finish". This is a win-win situation, either they stay on the ball and beat their man or the combination play is quick and precise.

2v2 'locked in'



of players This small sided game is played with 8 outfield players and 2 goalkeepers. A variation can be played by adding a neutral player (Pink) to create an overload.

organisation Players are set-up in 2-2 formation in each half. The players look to pass forward and must outplay their opponent to score and win.

objective This game is played with normal football rules, although I like to remove corners and throw-ins to get more interaction between the players.

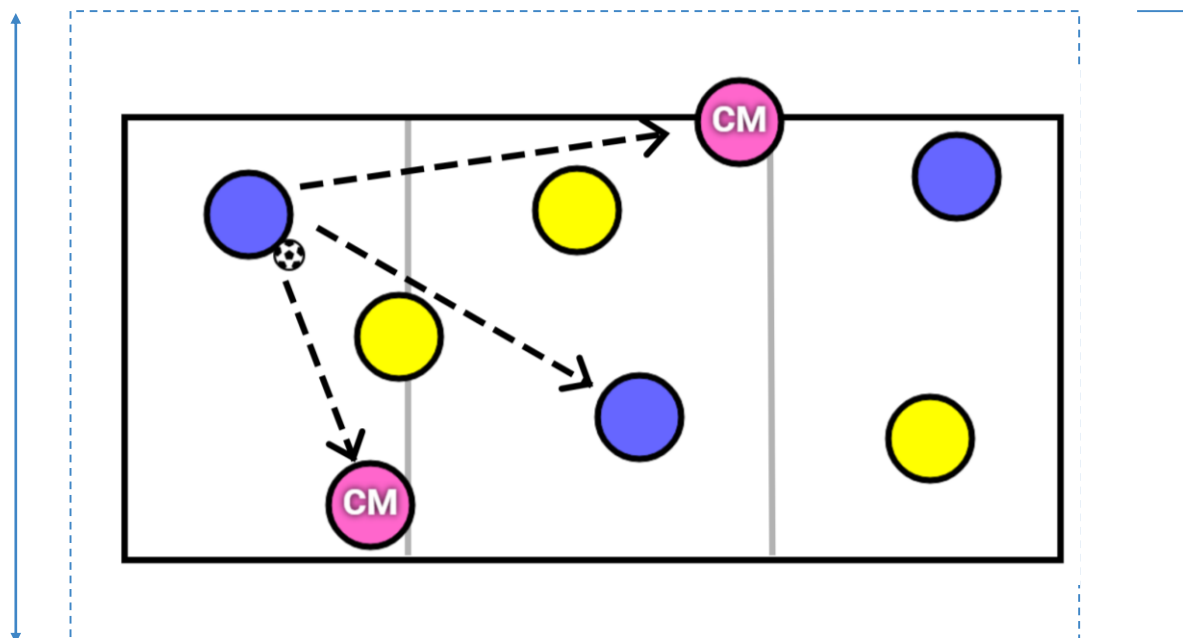
observe The players must play out from the goalkeeper and then attack in a 1v1/2v2 situation. In this game you could observe the following:

- How the players create supporting positions to receive the ball.
- How will they outplay or combine to get success?
- Movement to receive and movement for each other.

progressions Add a neutral player to create a constant overload situation (diagram 2). This will create 3v2 situations when attacking.

Central midfielder relationships

33



of players Minimum group size for this practice is 7, but I think it works best with 8 as per the diagram.

organisation The area is split into 3 equal thirds. The Yellows and Blues are split into 3x 1v1, one in each third. To start the practice these players are 'locked in' their area. The neutral players (Pink) can play in any area and support the team in possession.

objective To start this a possession based practice, with each team looking to play through all 3 boxes.

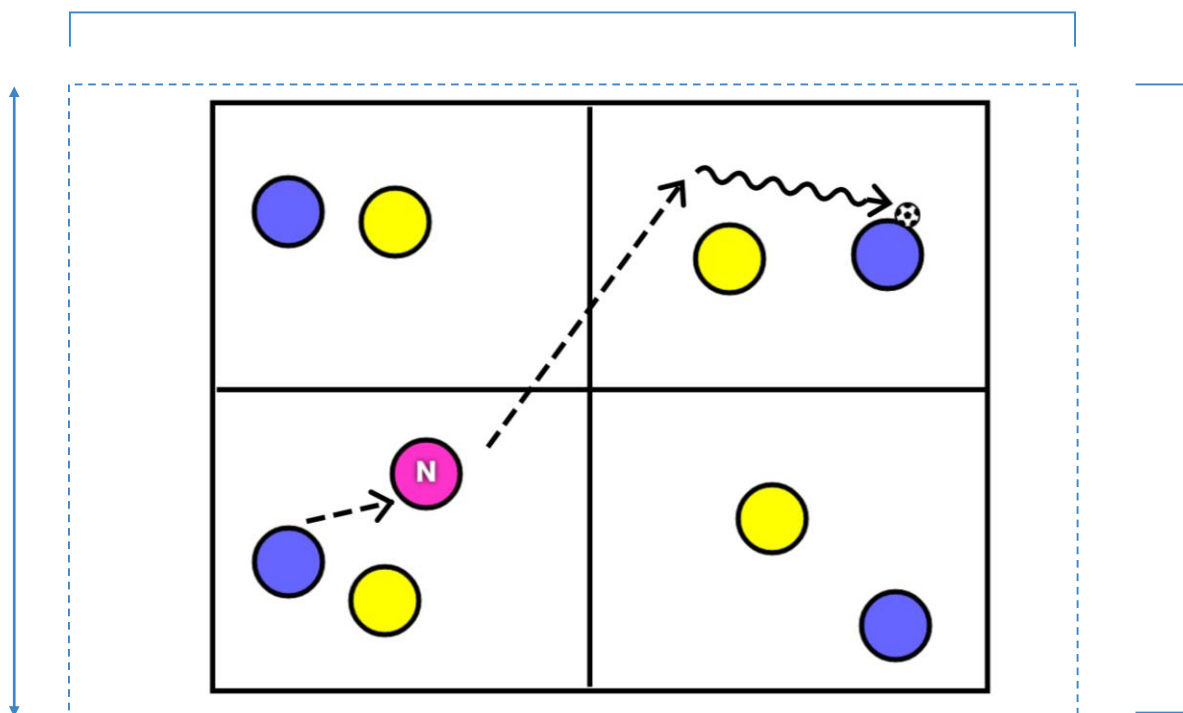
observe The players on both teams will have to outplay their opponent and choose the right moment to play through the thirds. The Pinks have to support quickly to create 2v1's opportunities.

progressions Suggested scoring mechanisms;

- Play through all 3 boxes for a point.
- Play directional to replicate playing through the thirds, dribbling over the end line to score.
- Allow rotation between boxes, still keeping a 1-1-1 formation - so never 2 players from the same team in the same box.
- Add target goals.
- Add a breakout to a larger goal.

Magic man!

34



of players Minimum group size is 9, but this can be adapted easily.

organisation Similar to the previous practice the Yellows and Blues are locked in to a quarter each with the Pink (neutral) player looking to support the team and player in possession, creating a spare man.

objective The team look to keep possession away from the opposition, outplaying their direct opponent and using the overload where necessary.

observe How does the player move off the ball to create an angle for his teammate to pass?

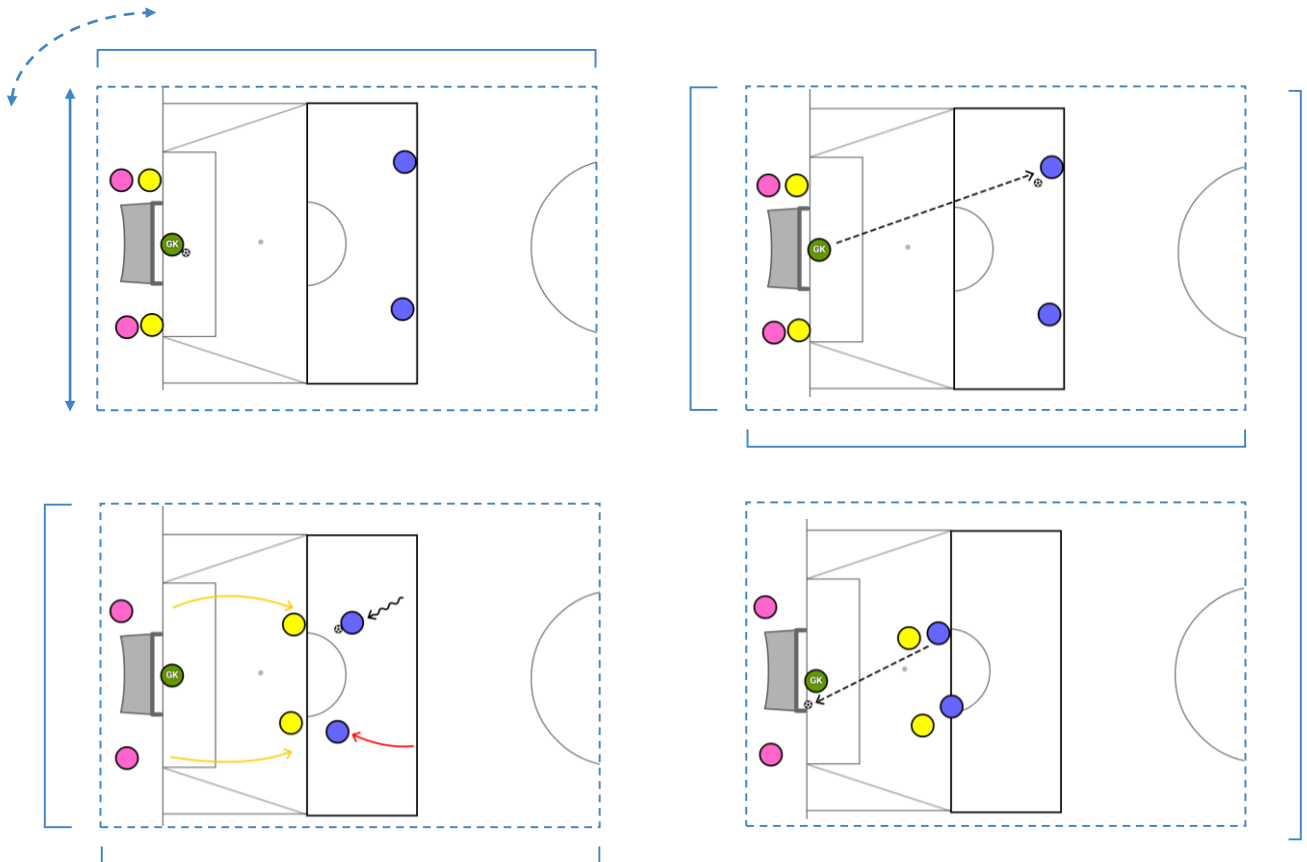
Does he create space to receive and outplay his direct opponent?

Does the neutral player make appropriate decisions to support the player on the ball – distance and angles of support will be key!

progressions A progression could be to remove the boxes.

2v2 Finishing

35



of players Minimum group size is 4, with a goalkeeper. This practice is quite physically demanding so will easily work with 8 players.

organisation The first attacking pair (Blue) start at the top of the area, the goalkeeper starts the practice by distributing the ball directly to them. This is the trigger for the defenders to engage (Picture 3 – Bottom Left). The attackers look to score in the goal, the Yellows would then play against the Pink.

objective To outplay as either an individual or a pair to score!

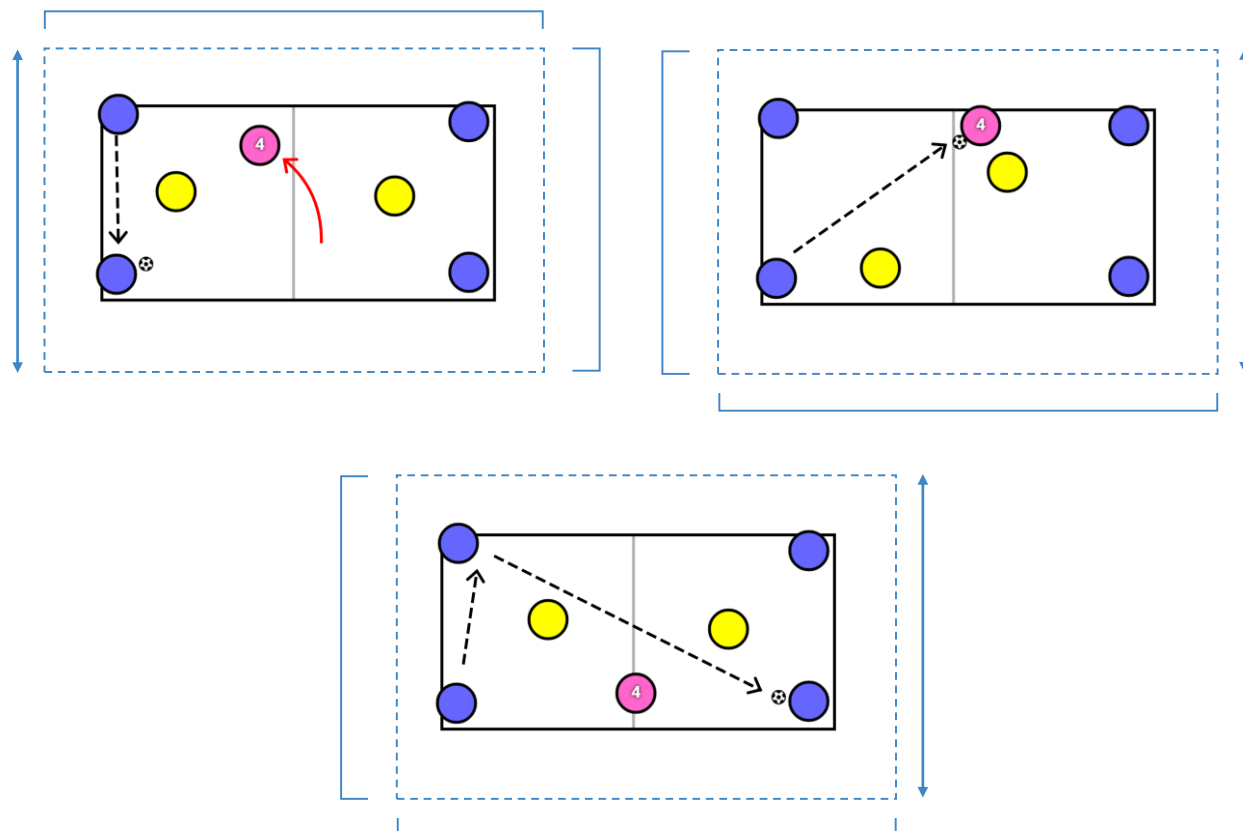
observe Does the supporting player take up appropriate positions to;

- Receive the ball?
- Stay on side?
- Draw a defender away to create a 1v1?

Are the attackers able to;

- Finish with variety?
- Finish under pressure?
- Beat players in face-to-face scenarios?

Hook the #9



of players This practice works with 7 players.

organisation In this practice the 2 Blues play in each half versus 1 defender (Yellow). The Pink can play in either half and looks to replicate a #4/#6/DCM when playing out from the back, from the 2 central defenders.

objective The Blue players and the Pink, look to 'hook' the #9 (Yellow) and play into the next half.

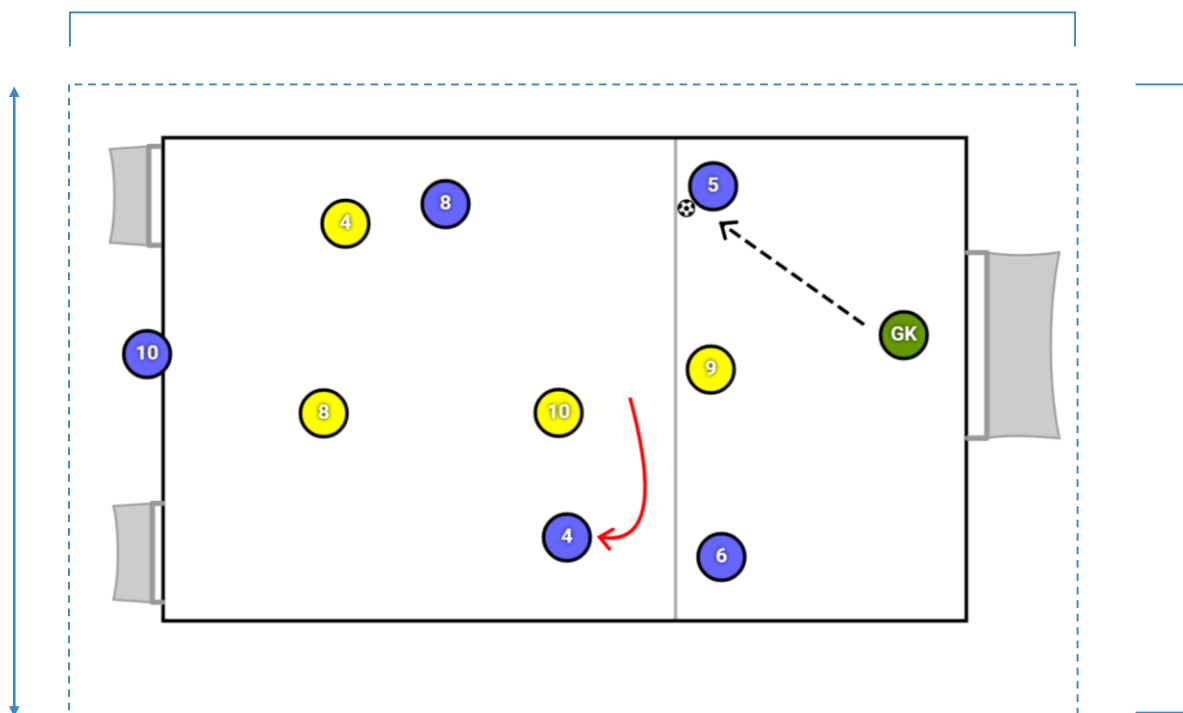
observe Picture 1 (Top Left) - I encourage the Pink to play on the opposite side of the ball, I feel this creates more passing lines for the player in possession of the ball.

Picture 2 (Top Right) - If possible he should look to play as high as possible to break the line of pressure.

Picture 3 (Bottom) - There is a skill in standing still and allowing your teammates to get success. The correct positioning might allow your teammate to play a great pass.

Playing out

37



of players This practice works with 9 outfield players and a goalkeeper.

organisation The Blues are playing out from the goalkeeper into 2 target goals, the #5 and #6 play 2v1 against a Yellow #9, with the Yellow midfield 3 playing against 2 Blue midfielders. The #10 Blue plays between the goals and can be used as a bounce player.

objective The Blues look to play out from the back and score in the target goals, the Yellows must press, regain and score in the larger goal – past the goalkeeper.

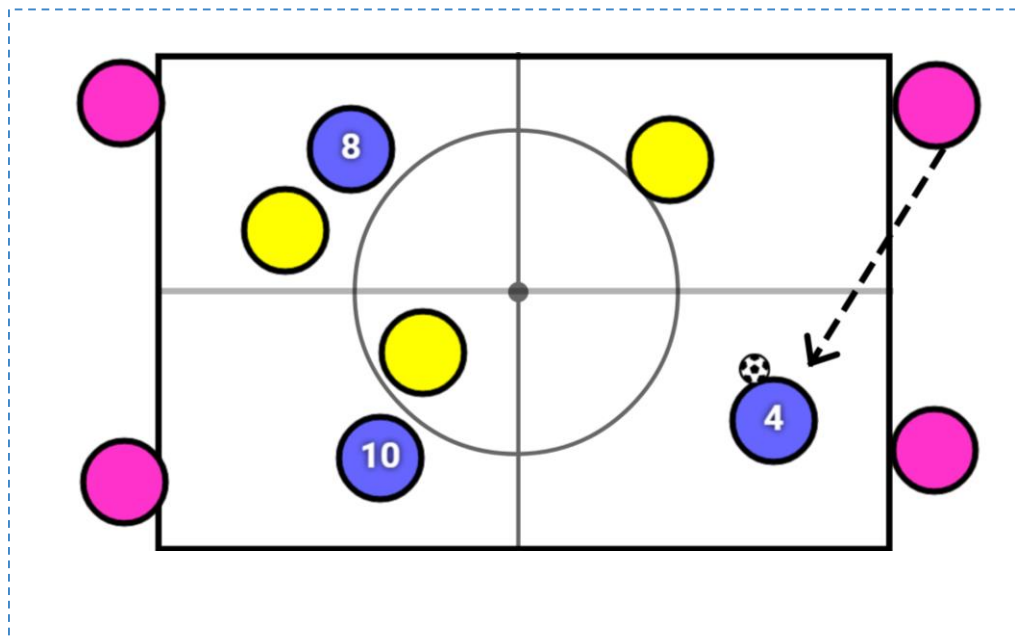
observe This practice works with larger numbers but will give repetition of receiving, outplaying, passing and supporting in 'pictures' that replicate the game.

progressions If needed the Blue #10 can be free, although I like the principle of keeping him higher to replicate his role in a 4-3-3/ 4-3-2-1.

Remove the zones.

Adjust the formation to stress individuals, e.g. 2 up top.

Midfield rotation



of players This practice works with 10 players.

organisation Yellows and Blues play 3v3 to replicate a midfield 3, with 2 target players (Pink), at each end.

objective The area is split into 4 quarters, to give the players reference, looking to 'fill' 3 of the 4 at all times. It is also quite an easy way to introduce the concept of rotation – as players look to 'empty and fill' each others spaces.

For the Pinks, lots of repetition of playing into midfield.

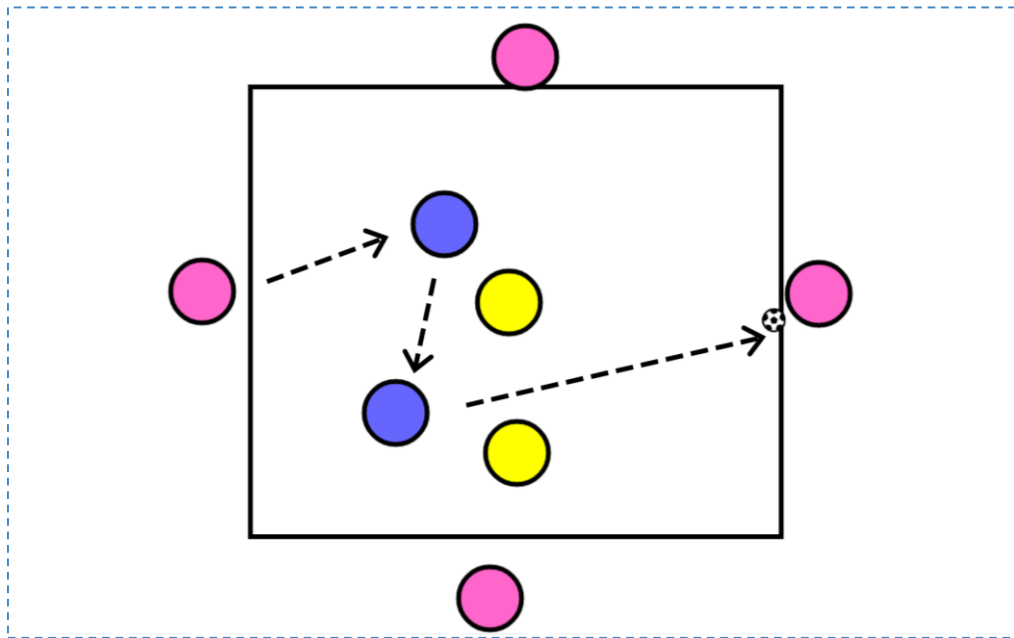
observe Are the players able to get appropriate distances from each other and fill 3 of the 4 spaces?

Are the players aware of their teammates movements, whilst keeping an eye on the ball?

Do the players recognise when and how to combine to play through central areas?

progressions This practice can be developed into a SSG with teams playing a Gk-2-3-1 formation.

2v2 Connection



of players This practice works with 8 players.

organisation This practice develops some of the concepts introduced in '1v1 multi-directional' practice (15). The 4 outside players (Pink) are neutral and play for the team in possession. The Blues and Yellows play a 2v2 inside the grid.

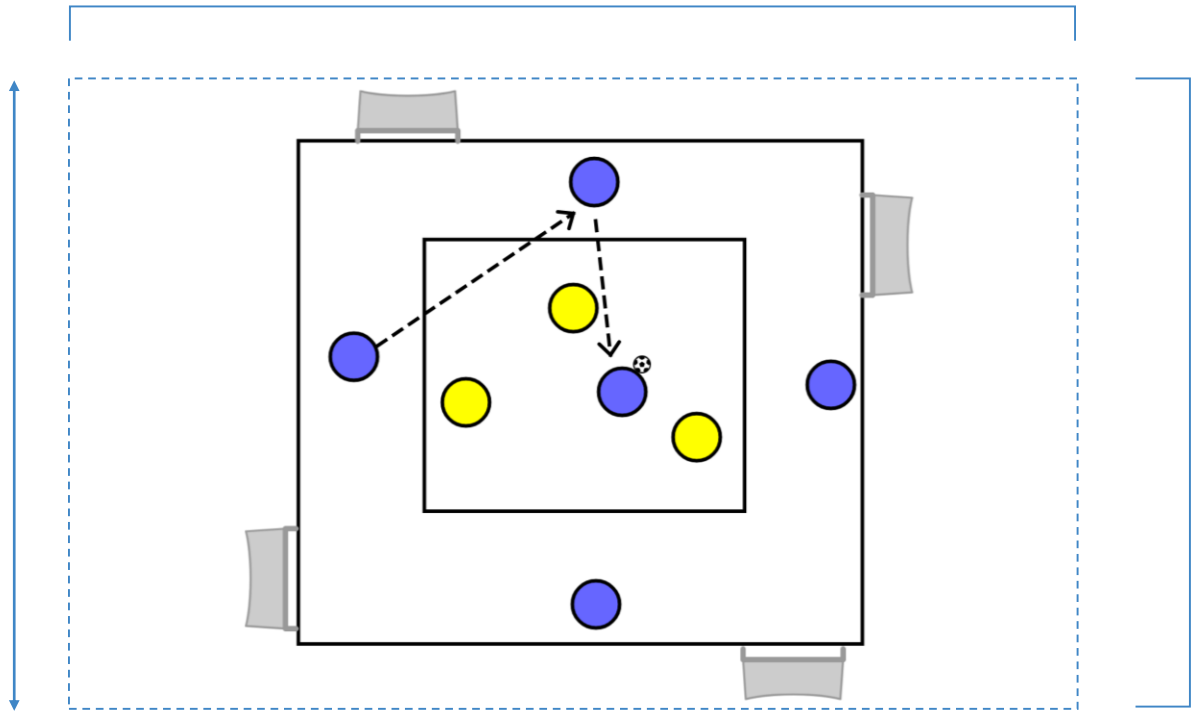
objective The Blues/Yellows must receive the ball from one Pink player, connect between teammates (i.e. Blue with Blue) before finding a different Pink player. This replicates playing forward or switching play.

observe This practice is challenging for the team in possession as what they want to do (connect a pass) isn't always an option, this means they have to adapt regularly – moving the ball as an individual or using the spare players. The practice also recreates passing and receiving under pressure, as each pass will be different and players will need to be able to adapt to the emerging gaps and opportunities for action.

progressions Play first to 3, winner stays on.
Restrict the touches for the Pink players.
Remove the option to pass back to the Pink.

This practice can be adapted, so one team plays North-South and the other East-West.

#10 receiving in the pocket



of players This practice takes place with 8 players in total.

organisation The Blue team (attackers) are set up with 4 players outside the internal grid, with 1 inside. The Yellows (defending) have 3 inside the smaller grid. The Yellows look to regain and score in any of the target goals. The outside Blue players can protect the goals and tackle/intercept.

objective The Blue team score by penetrating the box, with a point scored when:

- They connect a pass from the opposite side (third line pass).
- The #10 receives the ball and plays to a different side (switching play).

observe The position and body shape of the central player is key in this practice, how does he create space or manipulate the defenders to get success as an individual?

Alternatively, is he able to drag the Yellows out of shape so his teammates can break lines?



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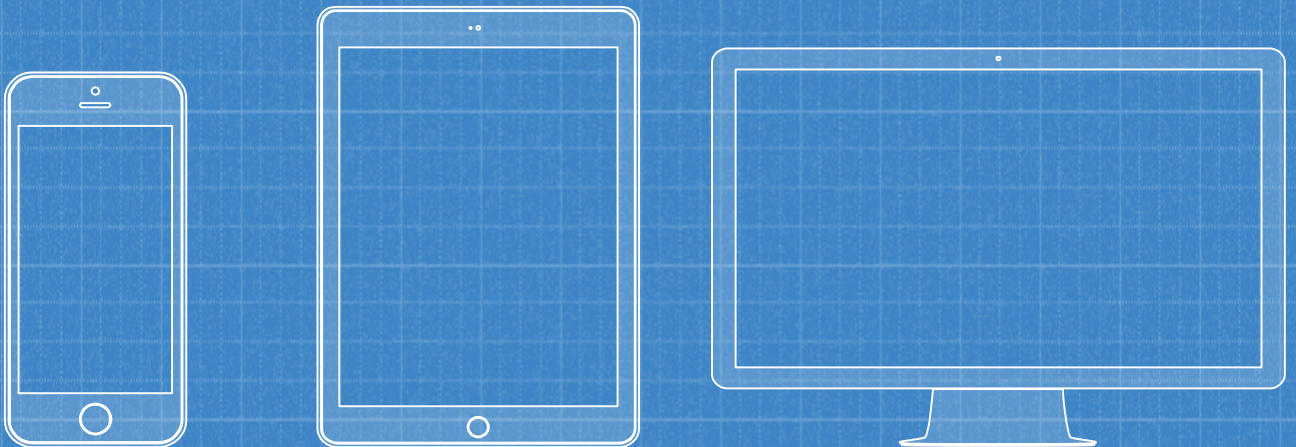
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